

# *Julius Caesar*

William Shakespeare · 1599

First Folio (1623) text as edited by Standard Ebooks

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

19 scene lessons plus 2 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 23 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 5 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

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# Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–19), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

**Edition:** Julius Caesar survives only in the 1623 First Folio; it was first performed in 1599 at the new Globe. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 18 scenes (plus the cast list). Shakespeare's main source was Thomas North's 1579 English translation of Plutarch's Lives. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

**Content note for teachers:** Political assassination on stage, mob violence, battle deaths and three suicides (one reported); Roman ideas of honorable suicide need careful, critical discussion. See the scene notes and the safe-messaging script.

**Grades:** Grades 9–10 (also 8 with support; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these plays are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 5. **Class days:** 23 × 90 minutes (19 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

## Essential questions

- What does Julius Caesar suggest about power, ambition and tyranny?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about honor and self-deception?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about rhetoric and persuasion?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about public versus private self?
- What does Julius Caesar suggest about fate, omens and free will?

## Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the play.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

## Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE
- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

**Primary codes:** RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
**Assessments:** Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
**Differentiation:** Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
**Materials:** Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

## The 90-minute lesson

| # | Segment | Mode | Minutes | Clock |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bell-ringer | You do | 8 | 0–8 |
| 2 | Vocabulary with etymology notes | I do | 10 | 8–18 |
| 3 | Background and context | I do | 10 | 18–28 |
| 4 | I do: modeled close reading | I do | 12 | 28–40 |
| 5 | We do: guided annotation | We do | 15 | 40–55 |
| 6 | You do: independent annotation | You do | 15 | 55–70 |
| 7 | Discussion | We do | 10 | 70–80 |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | Exit ticket / chapter quiz | You do | 7 | 80–87 |
| 9 | Closure | I do | 3 | 87–90 |
| | **Total** | | **90** | |

# Syllabus

| Week | Chapters | Lessons | Focus and activities | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Dramatis Personae<br>Act I, Scene I<br>Act I, Scene II<br>Act I, Scene III<br>Act II, Scene I | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *power, ambition and tyranny*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 2 | *Socratic seminar on power, ambition and tyranny*<br>Act II, Scene II<br>Act II, Scene III<br>Act II, Scene IV<br>Act III, Scene I | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *honor and self-deception*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on power, ambition and tyranny<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 3 | Act III, Scene II<br>Act III, Scene III<br>Act IV, Scene I<br>Act IV, Scene II<br>Act IV, Scene III | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *rhetoric and persuasion*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 4 | Act V, Scene I<br>*Socratic seminar on honor and self-deception*<br>Act V, Scene II<br>Act V, Scene III<br>Act V, Scene IV | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *public versus private self*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on honor and self-deception<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 5 | Act V, Scene V<br>*Whole-book test (90 minutes)*<br>*Final essay workshop and submission* | 3 × 90 min (270 min) | *fate, omens and free will*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure | Whole-book test and final essay |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | • Scene quizzes in the app<br>• Whole-book test (90 minutes)<br>• Final essay workshop and submission<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | |

# Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

# Lesson 1: Dramatis Personae

**Focus:** the cast and world of the play

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two poets, soldiers and servants; and two women, Calpurnia and Portia. The action moves from Rome to Sardis and the plains of Philippi.

**Background:** Shakespeare wrote the play in 1599, late in the reign of Elizabeth I, who was old, childless and had named no successor. Fears of civil war after a ruler's death made a story about a murdered leader and the war that followed timely. The story comes from Plutarch's Lives in North's translation; the real Caesar was killed on 15 March 44 BC.

**Significance:** The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are rhetoric, disrobe, handiwork, trophies, cobbler. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric" In this sentence it means: the art of persuasive speaking. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Shakespeare wrote the play in 1599, late in the reign of Elizabeth I, who was old, childless and had named no successor. Fears of civil war after a ruler's death made a story about a murdered leader and the war that followed timely. The story comes from Plutarch's Lives in North's translation; the real Caesar was killed on 15 March 44 BC. Why does this scene matter? The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Julius Caesar" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the cast and world of the play? When I find setting, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for setting.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Julius Caesar*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Characterization, Structure: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the cast and world of the play, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the cast and world of the play. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **rhetoric** (noun) | the art of persuasive speaking | *Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **disrobe** (verb) | to strip (statues) of their decorations | *Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **handiwork** (noun) | the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended) | *As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **trophies** (noun) | decorations hung in honor of a victory | *It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **cobbler** (noun) | a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker) | *Truly, sir, in respect of a fine workman, I am but, as you would say, a cobbler.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ingratitude** (noun) | failure to show thanks | *Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods to intermit the plague That needs must light on this ingratitude.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **naughty** (adjective) | wicked; good-for-nothing | *What trade, thou knave? thou naughty knave, what trade?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **surgeon** (noun) | one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes) | *I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

## *Discussion questions*

1. Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

## *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. Which characters on the cast list are conspirators against Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber and Cinna.
2. Who are the two women named in the cast list? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Calpurnia and Portia
3. Which three men become triumvirs after Caesar's death? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Octavius, Antony and Lepidus
4. Whom is Calpurnia married to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Caesar
5. Where does the final battle of the play take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Philippi
6. What is Artemidorus's profession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A teacher of rhetoric
7. Retell the three most important events of “Dramatis Personae” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two poets, soldiers and servants; and two women, Calpurnia and Portia. The action moves from Rome to…
8. Who is on stage in “Dramatis Personae”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Dramatis Personae” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric” What does “rhetoric” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: rhetoric: the art of persuasive speaking.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why might a play about killing a ruler have felt dangerous in London in 1599? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Elizabeth was old with no named heir; succession and rebellion were live fears.
2. What does “Dramatis Personae” suggest about the cast and world of the play? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

5. In the passage that begins “Julius Caesar”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: The cast list names Julius Caesar; the triumvirs who rule after his death (Octavius Caesar, Mark Antony, Lepidus); the conspirators (Marcus Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Trebonius, Ligarius, Decius Brutus, Metellus Cimber, Cinna); senators, tribunes, a soothsayer, the teacher of rhetoric Artemidorus, two…
7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Julius Caesar will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever right to remove a leader by force to protect a republic? What would have to be true first?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. The play is named for Caesar, yet he appears in few scenes. Who do you predict is the true center of the play, and why? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Brutus is a strong case: his choices and conscience drive the plot.
2. A critic might argue: “The cast list already divides the world into factions: Caesar's party, the conspirators, and the later triumvirate. Noticing that only two women appear, both as wives, helps students later ask who has a voice in public life.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the cast and world of the play. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Dramatis Personae" treats the cast and world of the play with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act I, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who are the two women named in the cast list?
   A. Lucretia and Portia
   B. Calpurnia and Cleopatra
   C. Calpurnia and Portia
   D. Portia and Octavia
2. Which three men become triumvirs after Caesar's death?
   A. Antony, Cicero and Lepidus
   B. Octavius, Antony and Lepidus
   C. Brutus, Cassius and Casca
   D. Octavius, Brutus and Antony
3. Whom is Calpurnia married to?
   A. Brutus
   B. Cassius
   C. Caesar
   D. Antony
4. Where does the final battle of the play take place?
   A. Rome

B. Pharsalus

C. Sardis

D. Philippi

5. What is Artemidorus's profession?

A. A senator

B. A poet

C. A soothsayer

D. A teacher of rhetoric

6. In the line “Artemidorus of Cnidos, a teacher of rhetoric”, what does “rhetoric” most nearly mean?

A. to strip (statues) of their decorations

B. decorations hung in honor of a victory

C. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)

D. the art of persuasive speaking

7. In the line “Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck’d with ceremonies.”, what does “disrobe” most nearly mean?

A. to strip (statues) of their decorations

B. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)

C. the art of persuasive speaking

D. decorations hung in honor of a victory

**Answer key:** 1. C (Calpurnia and Portia); 2. B (Octavius, Antony and Lepidus); 3. C (Caesar); 4. D (Philippi); 5. D (A teacher of rhetoric); 6. D (the art of persuasive speaking); 7. A (to strip (statues) of their decorations)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Dramatis Personae,” how does Shakespeare show the cast and world of the play? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Dramatis Personae, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the cast and world of the play? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the cast

and world of the play. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the cast and world of the play. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Dramatis Personae within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the cast and world of the play responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Dramatis Personae alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the cast and world of the play follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Dramatis Personae and its treatment of the cast and world of the play. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Dramatis Personae as evidence for a larger claim about the cast and world of the play in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Dramatis Personae as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the cast and world of the play. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*

As used in the text, what does the word “handiwork” most nearly mean?

A. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)

B. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)

C. wicked; good-for-nothing

D. failure to show thanks

2. *Julius Caesar*

Which choice best states a central concern of “Dramatis Personae”?

A. The funeral orations

B. Brutus and Cassius at odds

C. Artemidorus's letter

D. The cast and world of the play

**SAT key:** 1. B (the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)); 2. D (The cast and world of the play)

## Lesson 2: Act I, Scene I

**Focus:** the tribunes and the fickle crowd

Teacher only · spoilers

Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's statues so that he will not soar 'above the view of men.'

**Background:** Tribunes were officials elected to protect ordinary citizens (plebeians). Caesar had defeated Pompey in civil war and then Pompey's sons in 45 BC. Celebrating a victory over fellow Romans was controversial.

**Significance:** The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are disrobe, handiwork, trophies, cobbler, ingratitude. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies." In this sentence it means: to strip (statues) of their decorations. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Tribunes were officials elected to protect ordinary citizens (plebeians). Caesar had defeated Pompey in civil war and then Pompey's sons in 45 BC. Celebrating a victory over fellow Romans was controversial. Why does this scene matter? The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman's matters, nor women's matters, but with awl." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the tribunes and the fickle crowd? I circle "handiwork", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find setting, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for setting.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman's matters, nor women's matters, but with awl. I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them. As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Characterization, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the tribunes and the fickle crowd, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## Vocabulary with etymology notes

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **disrobe** (verb) | to strip (statues) of their decorations | *Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **handiwork** (noun) | the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended) | *As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **trophies** (noun) | decorations hung in honor of a victory | *It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **cobbler** (noun) | a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker) | *Truly, sir, in respect of a fine workman, I am but, as you would say, a cobbler.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ingratitude** (noun) | failure to show thanks | *Run to your houses, fall upon your knees, Pray to the gods to intermit the plague That needs must light on this ingratitude.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **naughty** (adjective) | wicked; good-for-nothing | *What trade, thou knave? thou naughty knave, what trade?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **surgeon** (noun) | one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes) | *I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | to beg | *Nay, I beseech you, sir, be not out with me: yet, if you be out, sir, I can mend you.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

## Discussion questions

1. Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

## Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does Marullus say the crowd once did for Pompey? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Climbed walls and towers and waited all day to see him pass.
2. Why are the commoners out in the streets? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: To celebrate Caesar's triumph
3. What trade does the punning commoner follow? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cobbler
4. Whose earlier triumphs does Marullus remind the crowd they cheered? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Pompey's
5. What do the tribunes plan to do to Caesar's statues? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Strip off their decorations
6. How do Flavius and Marullus feel about Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: They oppose his rising power
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's statues so that he will not soar 'above the view of men.'
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck'd with ceremonies." What does "disrobe" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: disrobe: to strip (statues) of their decorations.

### Inferential / analytical

1. What does Flavius's image of plucking 'feathers' from Caesar's wing suggest about how he sees Caesar? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: As a bird of prey who would fly too high and rule over others.
2. What does "Act I, Scene I" suggest about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

5. In the passage that begins “Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman’s matters, nor women’s matters, but with awl.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Commoners take a holiday to celebrate Caesar's triumph over Pompey's sons. The tribunes Flavius and Marullus scold them; a cobbler answers with puns. Marullus reminds them they once cheered Pompey, calls them ungrateful, and sends them home. The tribunes then go to strip decorations from Caesar's…
7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you seen a crowd or online audience switch sides quickly? What made it change?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Are the tribunes defending the people or insulting them? Use their words to argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Both: they guard the republic but call the people blocks and stones.
2. A critic might argue: “The first scene introduces the crowd as changeable: it cheered Pompey and now cheers Caesar. That sets up Act III, when Brutus and then Antony each win the same crowd within minutes.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Act I, Scene I" treats the tribunes and the fickle crowd with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act I, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tribunes and the fickle crowd? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Why are the commoners out in the streets?
   A. To protest taxes
   B. To elect tribunes
   C. To celebrate Caesar's triumph
   D. To see a play
2. What trade does the punning commoner follow?
   A. Baker
   B. Butcher
   C. Cobbler
   D. Carpenter
3. Whose earlier triumphs does Marullus remind the crowd they cheered?
   A. Antony's
   B. Pompey's
   C. Cicero's
   D. Brutus's
4. What do the tribunes plan to do to Caesar's statues?
   A. Paint them
   B. Strip off their decorations
   C. Guard them
   D. Pull them down

5. How do Flavius and Marullus feel about Caesar?
   A. They fear the crowd more than him
   B. They oppose his rising power
   C. They love him
   D. They do not care
6. In the line “Go you down that way towards the Capitol; This way will I: disrobe the images, If you do find them deck’d with ceremonies.”, what does “disrobe” most nearly mean?
   A. decorations hung in honor of a victory
   B. a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)
   C. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)
   D. to strip (statues) of their decorations
7. In the line “As proper men as ever trod upon neat’s leather have gone upon my handiwork.”, what does “handiwork” most nearly mean?
   A. decorations hung in honor of a victory
   B. the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended)
   C. to strip (statues) of their decorations
   D. a shoe mender (also a pun on a clumsy worker)

**Answer key:** 1. C (To celebrate Caesar's triumph); 2. C (Cobbler); 3. B (Pompey's); 4. B (Strip off their decorations); 5. B (They oppose his rising power); 6. D (to strip (statues) of their decorations); 7. B (the work of one's hands (here, the shoes he has mended))

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the tribunes and the fickle crowd? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act I, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the tribunes and the fickle crowd follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene I and its treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the tribunes and the fickle crowd in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the tribunes and the fickle crowd. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *It is no matter; let no images Be hung with Caesar's trophies.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "trophies" most nearly mean?

   A. wicked; good-for-nothing

   B. to beg

   C. decorations hung in honor of a victory

   D. one who heals (here, a joke: he "heals" old shoes)

2. *Truly, sir, all that I live by is with the awl: I meddle with no tradesman's matters, nor women's matters, but with awl. I am, indeed, sir, a surgeon to old shoes; when they are in great danger, I recover them. As proper men as ever trod upon neat's leather have gone upon my handiwork.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

A. The funeral orations

B. Parley before battle

C. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

D. Cinna the poet

**SAT key:** 1. C (decorations hung in honor of a victory); 2. C (The tribunes and the fickle crowd)

## Lesson 3: Act I, Scene II

**Focus:** Cassius works on Brutus

Teacher only · spoilers

At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Caesar tells Antony he distrusts Cassius's 'lean and hungry look.' Casca reports that Caesar refused a crown offered three times by Antony and then fell in a fit. Alone, Cassius plans to throw forged letters in Brutus's window.

**Background:** The Lupercalia was a February fertility festival. The 'ides' of March was 15 March. Caesar was made dictator for life in early 44 BC, which alarmed defenders of the republic.

**Significance:** This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are bestride, coronets, underlings, cogitations, encompass. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves." In this sentence it means: to stand over with legs wide apart. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. The Lupercalia was a February fertility festival. The 'ides' of March was 15 March. Caesar was made dictator for life in early 44 BC, which alarmed defenders of the republic. Why does this scene matter? This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to Cassius works on Brutus? I circle "wenches", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut. An I had been a man of any occupation, if I would not have taken him at a word, I would I might go to hell among the rogues. And so he fell. When he came to himself again, he said, If he had done or said anything amiss, he desired their worships to think it was his infirmity. Three or four wenches, where I stood, cried "Alas, good soul!" and forgave him with all their hearts: but there's no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Conflict, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about Cassius works on Brutus, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Cassius works on Brutus. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bestride** (verb) | to stand over with legs wide apart | *Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **coronets** (noun) | small crowns | *I saw Mark Antony offer him a crown;—yet 'twas not a crown neither, 'twas one of these coronets;—and, as I told you, he put it by once: but, for all that, to my thinking, he would fain have had it.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **underlings** (noun) | inferiors; people of low rank | *Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **cogitations** (noun) | thoughts | *Then, Brutus, I have much mistook your passion; By means whereof this breast of mine hath buried Thoughts of great value, worthy cogitations.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **encompass** (verb) | to enclose; to contain | *When could they say till now, that talk'd of Rome, That her wide walls encompass'd but one man?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **foolery** (noun) | foolish behavior; nonsense | *I can as well be hanged as tell the manner of it: it was mere foolery; I did not mark it.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **wenches** (noun) | young women (informal, period term) | *Three or four wenches, where I stood, cried "Alas, good soul!" and forgave him with all their hearts: but there's no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enterprise** (noun) | a bold undertaking | *So is he now in execution Of any bold or noble enterprise, However he puts on this tardy form.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **chanced** (verb) | happened | *Ay, Casca; tell us what hath chanced to-day, That Caesar looks so sad.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ceremony** (noun) | formal politeness | *Set on; and leave no ceremony out.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. What does Brutus admit he fears when he hears the crowd shout? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: That the people choose Caesar for their king.
2. What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The ides of March
3. From what danger does Cassius say he once saved Caesar? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Drowning in the Tiber
4. How many times does Antony offer Caesar the crown, according to Casca? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Three
5. What does Caesar say about Cassius's appearance? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He has a lean and hungry look
6. What does Cassius plan to put in Brutus's window? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Letters in several hands
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act I, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Caesar tells Antony he distrusts Cassius's 'lean and hungry look.' Casca…
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act I, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves.” What does “bestride” mean here, and

what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: bestride: to stand over with legs wide apart.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius tell stories of Caesar's physical weakness? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: To show Caesar is only a man, no greater than Brutus or Cassius.
2. What does “Act I, Scene II” suggest about Cassius works on Brutus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about Cassius works on Brutus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
5. In the passage that begins “Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: At the feast of Lupercal a soothsayer warns Caesar to beware the ides of March; Caesar dismisses him. Cassius probes Brutus, who admits he fears the people will choose Caesar for king. Cassius tells how he saved Caesar from drowning and saw him sick with fever, and argues 'the fault... is not in…
7. How does “Act I, Scene II” build on “Act I, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When someone flatters you to win you over, how can you tell?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

### Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. 'The fault... is not in our stars, but in ourselves.' Does the play prove Cassius right or wrong? Revisit this at the end. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Debatable: omens come true, yet characters' choices cause each disaster.

2. A critic might argue: “This long scene shows Cassius's method of persuasion (flattery, comparison, personal grievance) and Brutus's weak point: his public honor. Caesar's private weaknesses (deafness in one ear, fits) contrast with his public godlike pose.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Cassius works on Brutus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Cassius works on Brutus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Cassius works on Brutus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware?

   A. The Capitol

   B. Cassius

   C. The Lupercal

   D. The ides of March

2. From what danger does Cassius say he once saved Caesar?
   A. A wild boar
   B. An assassin
   C. Drowning in the Tiber
   D. A fire
3. How many times does Antony offer Caesar the crown, according to Casca?
   A. Once
   B. Three
   C. Twice
   D. Five
4. What does Caesar say about Cassius's appearance?
   A. He looks ill
   B. He looks like a king
   C. He looks too cheerful
   D. He has a lean and hungry look
5. What does Cassius plan to put in Brutus's window?
   A. Letters in several hands
   B. A crown
   C. A warning from Calpurnia
   D. A dagger
6. In the line "Why, man, he doth bestride the narrow world Like a Colossus, and we petty men Walk under his huge legs and peep about To find ourselves dishonourable graves.", what does "bestride" most nearly mean?
   A. small crowns
   B. inferiors; people of low rank
   C. thoughts
   D. to stand over with legs wide apart
7. In the line "I saw Mark Antony offer him a crown;—yet 'twas not a crown neither, 'twas one of these coronets;—and, as I told you, he put it by once: but, for all that, to my thinking, he would fain have had it.", what does "coronets" most nearly mean?
   A. inferiors; people of low rank
   B. to stand over with legs wide apart
   C. thoughts
   D. small crowns

**Answer key:** 1. D (The ides of March); 2. C (Drowning in the Tiber); 3. B (Three); 4. D (He has a lean and hungry look); 5. A (Letters in several hands); 6. D (to stand over with legs wide apart); 7. D (small crowns)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Cassius works on Brutus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act I, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Cassius works on Brutus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Cassius works on Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Cassius works on Brutus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Cassius works on Brutus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Cassius works on Brutus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Cassius works on Brutus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Cassius works on Brutus follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene II

and its treatment of Cassius works on Brutus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Cassius works on Brutus in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Cassius works on Brutus. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Men at some time are masters of their fates: The fault, dear Brutus, is not in our stars, But in ourselves, that we are underlings.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “underlings” most nearly mean?

   A. inferiors; people of low rank

   B. formal politeness

   C. a bold undertaking

   D. happened

2. *Marry, before he fell down, when he perceived the common herd was glad he refused the crown, he plucked me ope his doublet and offered them his throat to cut. An I had been a man of any occupation, if I would not have taken him at a word, I would I might go to hell among the rogues. And so he fell. When he came to himself again, he said, If he had done or said anything amiss, he desired their worships to think it was his infirmity. Three or four wenches, where I stood, cried “Alas, good soul!” and forgave him with all their hearts: but there’s no heed to be taken of them: if Caesar had stabbed their mothers, they would have done no less.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act I, Scene II”?

   A. The assassination

   B. Artemidorus's letter

   C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   D. Cassius works on Brutus

**SAT key:** 1. A (inferiors; people of low rank); 2. D (Cassius works on Brutus)

## Lesson 4: Act I, Scene III

**Focus:** storm, omens and recruitment

Teacher only · spoilers

On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna joins them; Cassius sends him to place forged letters where Brutus will find them, and they agree that Brutus's good name will make their deed look like virtue.

**Background:** Romans read storms and unusual events (prodigies) as messages from the gods. Plutarch records omens before Caesar's death. Cicero, a famous orator, was not part of the plot.

**Significance:** The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are bondman, construe, illuminate, alchemy, shrieking. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity." In this sentence it means: a slave. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Romans read storms and unusual events (prodigies) as messages from the gods. Plutarch records omens before Caesar's death. Cicero, a famous orator, was not part of the plot. Why does this scene matter? The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for setting.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join'd, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain'd unscorch'd." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to storm, omens and recruitment? I circle "shrieking", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find setting, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for setting.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of setting. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join'd, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain'd unscorch'd. Besides—I ha' not since put up my sword— Against the Capitol I met a lion, Who glared upon me, and went surly by, Without annoying me: and there were drawn Upon a heap a hundred ghastly women, Transformed with their fear; who swore they saw Men all in fire walk up and down the streets. And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking. When these prodigies Do so conjointly meet, let not men say "These are their reasons; they are natural;" For, I believe, they are portentous things Unto the climate that they point upon.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Setting, Tone / mood, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about storm, omens and recruitment, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes storm, omens and recruitment. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bondman** (noun) | a slave | *So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **construe** (verb) | to interpret; to explain | *Indeed, it is a strange-disposed time: But men may construe things after their fashion, Clean from the purpose of the things themselves.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **illuminate** (verb) | make lighter or brighter | *Those that with haste will make a mighty fire Begin it with weak straws: what trash is Rome, What rubbish and what offal, when it serves For the base matter to illuminate So vile a thing as Caesar!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **alchemy** (noun) | the supposed art of turning base metal to gold | *O, he sits high in all the people's hearts: And that which would appear offence in us, His countenance, like richest alchemy, Will change to virtue and to worthiness.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **shrieking** (verb) | crying out with a high scream | *And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conceited** (verb) | understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped) | *Him and his worth and our great need of him You have right well conceited.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **husbanded** (adjective) | married; having a husband | *Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dismember** (verb) | to cut the limbs from a body | *We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Casca say the senators plan to do tomorrow? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Establish Caesar as king, to wear his crown everywhere except in Italy.
2. What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: It burned but was not scorched
3. Which wild animal does Casca say he met near the Capitol? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A lion
4. How does Cassius interpret the storm? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: As a warning against Caesar's tyranny
5. Who is sent to place the letters for Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cinna
6. Why do the conspirators want Brutus to join them? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna joins them; Cassius sends him to place forged letters where Brutus will find them, and they agree…
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act I, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity." What does "bondman" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: bondman: a slave.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Cassius say he would rather die than live under Caesar? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: He believes Romans who accept a tyrant become slaves; he will free himself.
2. What does "Act I, Scene III" suggest about storm, omens and recruitment? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The same omens are read

in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.

3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about storm, omens and recruitment? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
5. In the passage that begins “A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join’d, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain’d unscorch’d.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: On a night of thunder and strange sights (a slave's burning hand that does not burn, a lion near the Capitol, men on fire walking the streets, an owl hooting at noon), Casca meets Cicero and then Cassius. Cassius reads the omens as warnings against Caesar's tyranny and wins Casca to the plot. Cinna…
7. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do people tend to read signs and news in the way that fits what they already believe?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is it fair for the conspirators to use Brutus's reputation? What does that suggest about their cause? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: They borrow his virtue as cover; it suggests the cause needs disguising.
2. A critic might argue: “The same omens are read in opposite ways: Casca is terrified, Cassius turns them into an argument. The scene shows that interpretation is itself a tool of persuasion.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of storm, omens and recruitment. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats storm, omens and recruitment with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about storm, omens and recruitment? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand?
   A. It burned but was not scorched
   B. It held a crown
   C. It bled
   D. It turned to stone
2. Which wild animal does Casca say he met near the Capitol?
   A. A wolf
   B. A bear
   C. A lion
   D. A boar
3. How does Cassius interpret the storm?
   A. As meaningless

B. As a sign Caesar should be crowned

C. As a curse on Cassius

D. As a warning against Caesar's tyranny

4. Who is sent to place the letters for Brutus?

A. Decius

B. Trebonius

C. Cinna

D. Casca

5. Why do the conspirators want Brutus to join them?

A. He has money

B. He is the best soldier

C. He is Caesar's son

D. His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy

6. In the line “So can I: So every bondman in his own hand bears The power to cancel his captivity.”, what does “bondman” most nearly mean?

A. a slave

B. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

C. to interpret; to explain

D. make lighter or brighter

7. In the line “Indeed, it is a strange-disposed time: But men may construe things after their fashion, Clean from the purpose of the things themselves.”, what does “construe” most nearly mean?

A. a slave

B. the supposed art of turning base metal to gold

C. make lighter or brighter

D. to interpret; to explain

**Answer key:** 1. A (It burned but was not scorched); 2. C (A lion); 3. D (As a warning against Caesar's tyranny); 4. C (Cinna); 5. D (His good reputation will make the deed seem worthy); 6. A (a slave); 7. D (to interpret; to explain)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act I, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show storm, omens and recruitment? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act I, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of storm, omens and recruitment? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of storm, omens and recruitment. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of storm, omens and recruitment. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about storm, omens and recruitment. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of storm, omens and recruitment. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act I, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of storm, omens and recruitment responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act I, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of storm, omens and recruitment follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act I, Scene III and its treatment of storm, omens and recruitment. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act I, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about storm, omens and recruitment in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act I, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of storm, omens and recruitment. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist,

psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Those that with haste will make a mighty fire Begin it with weak straws: what trash is Rome, What rubbish and what offal, when it serves For the base matter to illuminate So vile a thing as Caesar!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "illuminate" most nearly mean?

   A. to cut the limbs from a body
   B. make lighter or brighter
   C. understood; judged (well conceited: rightly grasped)
   D. married; having a husband

2. *A common slave—you know him well by sight— Held up his left hand, which did flame and burn Like twenty torches join'd, and yet his hand, Not sensible of fire, remain'd unscorch'd. Besides—I ha' not since put up my sword— Against the Capitol I met a lion, Who glared upon me, and went surly by, Without annoying me: and there were drawn Upon a heap a hundred ghastly women, Transformed with their fear; who swore they saw Men all in fire walk up and down the streets. And yesterday the bird of night did sit Even at noon-day upon the market-place, Hooting and shrieking. When these prodigies Do so conjointly meet, let not men say "These are their reasons; they are natural;" For, I believe, they are portentous things Unto the climate that they point upon.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene III"?

   A. Parley before battle
   B. Cinna the poet
   C. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost
   D. Storm, omens and recruitment

**SAT key:** 1. B (make lighter or brighter); 2. D (Storm, omens and recruitment)

# Lesson 5: Act II, Scene I

**Focus:** Brutus decides

Teacher only · spoilers

Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan to kill Antony too: 'Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers.' Decius promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol. Portia, who has wounded her own thigh to prove her constancy, demands to share his secret. Ligarius, though sick, joins.

**Background:** Brutus's ancestor, Lucius Junius Brutus, was said to have driven out Rome's last king, Tarquin, and founded the republic. That family history weighs on Brutus.

**Significance:** Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are husbanded, dismember, unbraced, appertain, discard. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: “Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father’d and so husbanded?” In this sentence it means: married; having a husband. Word histories: “discard”: dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off." For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Brutus's ancestor, Lucius Junius Brutus, was said to have driven out Rome's last king, Tarquin, and founded the republic. That family history weighs on Brutus. Why does this scene matter? Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Let 'em enter." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to Brutus decides? I circle "prevention", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Let 'em enter. Exit Lucius. They are the faction. O conspiracy, Shamest thou to show thy dangerous brow by night, When evils are most free? O, then by day Where wilt thou find a cavern dark enough To mask thy monstrous visage? Seek none, conspiracy; Hide it in smiles and affability: For if thou path, thy native semblance on, Not Erebus itself were dim enough To hide thee from prevention.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Theme, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about Brutus decides, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Brutus decides. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **husbanded** (adjective) | married; having a husband | *Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dismember** (verb) | to cut the limbs from a body | *We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **unbraced** (adjective) | with clothing unfastened | *Is Brutus sick? and is it physical To walk unbraced and suck up the humours Of the dank morning?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **appertain** (verb) | to belong to or be connected with | *Within the bond of marriage, tell me, Brutus, Is it excepted I should know no secrets That appertain to you?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **discard** (verb) | to reject; to throw away | *By all the gods that Romans bow before, I here discard my sickness!* | "discard": dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/discard) |
| **prevention** (noun) | being stopped before acting | *Seek none, conspiracy; Hide it in smiles and affability: For if thou path, thy native semblance on, Not Erebus itself were dim enough To hide thee from prevention.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **suburbs** (noun) | outskirts; the edges of something | *Dwell I but in the suburbs Of your good pleasure?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **butchers** (noun) | people who kill savagely | *Our course will seem too bloody, Caius Cassius, To cut the head off and then hack the limbs, Like wrath in death and envy afterwards; For Antony is but a limb of Caesar: Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers, Caius.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conjured** (verb) | summon into action or bring into existence, | *Thou, like an exorcist, hast conjured up My mortified spirit.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | often as if by magic | | |
| **interpose** (verb) | be or come between | *What watchful cares do interpose themselves Betwixt your eyes and night?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. Whom did Brutus's ancestors drive from Rome, as he recalls while reading the letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Tarquin, Rome's last king.
2. To what does Brutus compare Caesar in his soliloquy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A serpent's egg
3. What does Brutus refuse to let the conspirators do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Swear an oath
4. Whom does Cassius want to kill along with Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Mark Antony
5. Who promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Decius Brutus
6. How has Portia proved her constancy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: She gave herself a wound in the thigh
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan to kill Antony too: 'Let us be sacrificers, but not butchers.' Decius promises to bring Caesar to…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father’d and so husbanded?” What does “husbanded” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: husbanded: married; having a husband.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. What does Brutus's admission that he has no quarrel with what Caesar has done reveal about his reasoning? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: His case rests on speculation about Caesar's future, not facts.
2. What does “Act II, Scene I” suggest about Brutus decides? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about Brutus decides? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
5. In the passage that begins “Let ’em enter.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Alone in his orchard at night, Brutus decides Caesar must die, not for what he has done but for what he might become: 'think him as a serpent's egg.' He reads a forged letter urging him to act. The conspirators arrive; Brutus refuses an oath, refuses to include Cicero, and overrules Cassius's plan…
7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act I, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it fair to punish someone for something they might do in the future?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Brutus calls the killing a sacrifice, not a butchery. Can how you name an act change what it is? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Strong answers weigh rhetoric against the reality of violence.

2. A critic might argue: “Brutus's soliloquy argues from fear of the future, not evidence. His three decisions here (no oath, no Cicero, spare Antony) each show idealism and each later harms the conspiracy.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Brutus decides. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene I” treats Brutus decides with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Brutus decides? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz*

1. To what does Brutus compare Caesar in his soliloquy?

   A. A serpent's egg

   B. A lion

   C. A falling star

   D. A storm

2. What does Brutus refuse to let the conspirators do?
   A. Meet at night
   B. Swear an oath
   C. Carry daggers
   D. Speak to Portia
3. Whom does Cassius want to kill along with Caesar?
   A. Lepidus
   B. Mark Antony
   C. Octavius
   D. Cicero
4. Who promises to bring Caesar to the Capitol?
   A. Decius Brutus
   B. Casca
   C. Cinna
   D. Metellus
5. How has Portia proved her constancy?
   A. She fasted for a week
   B. She spied on Caesar
   C. She gave herself a wound in the thigh
   D. She swore an oath
6. In the line "Think you I am no stronger than my sex, Being so father'd and so husbanded?", what does "husbanded" most nearly mean?
   A. with clothing unfastened
   B. married; having a husband
   C. to cut the limbs from a body
   D. to belong to or be connected with
7. In the line "We all stand up against the spirit of Caesar; And in the spirit of men there is no blood: O, that we then could come by Caesar's spirit, And not dismember Caesar!", what does "dismember" most nearly mean?
   A. married; having a husband
   B. to belong to or be connected with
   C. with clothing unfastened
   D. to cut the limbs from a body

**Answer key:** 1. A (A serpent's egg); 2. B (Swear an oath); 3. B (Mark Antony); 4. A (Decius Brutus); 5. C (She gave herself a wound in the thigh); 6. B (married; having a husband); 7. D (to cut the limbs from a body)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage

your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show Brutus decides? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act II, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Brutus decides? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of Brutus decides. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Brutus decides. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about Brutus decides. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of Brutus decides. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Brutus decides responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Brutus decides follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene I and its treatment of Brutus decides. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about Brutus decides in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Brutus decides. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Is Brutus sick? and is it physical To walk unbraced and suck up the humours Of the dank morning?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "unbraced" most nearly mean?

   A. be or come between

   B. summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic

   C. people who kill savagely

   D. with clothing unfastened

2. *Let 'em enter. Exit Lucius. They are the faction. O conspiracy, Shamest thou to show thy dangerous brow by night, When evils are most free? O, then by day Where wilt thou find a cavern dark enough To mask thy monstrous visage? Seek none, conspiracy; Hide it in smiles and affability: For if thou path, thy native semblance on, Not Erebus itself were dim enough To hide thee from prevention.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene I"?

   A. The first charge

   B. Brutus decides

   C. Cinna the poet

   D. The death of Brutus

**SAT key:** 1. D (with clothing unfastened); 2. B (Brutus decides)

## Lesson 6: Act II, Scene II

**Focus:** Calpurnia's dream

Teacher only · spoilers

Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome drawing life from Caesar, and says the Senate means to crown him and will mock him if he stays for a wife's dreams. Caesar goes; the conspirators and Antony arrive to escort him.

**Background:** Augurs were Roman priests who read the will of the gods in sacrifices and the flight of birds.

**Significance:** Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are predictions, expounded, purposed, entrails, beggars. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar." In this sentence it means: statements about what will happen. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Augurs were Roman priests who read the will of the gods in sacrifices and the flight of birds. Why does this scene matter? Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Cowards die many times before their deaths; The valiant never taste of death but once." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to Calpurnia's dream? I circle "wonders", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Cowards die many times before their deaths; The valiant never taste of death but once. Of all the wonders that I yet have heard, It seems to me most strange that men should fear; Seeing that death, a necessary end, Will come when it will come.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Conflict, Structure: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about Calpurnia's dream, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Calpurnia's dream. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **predictions** (noun) | statements about what will happen | *Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **expounded** (verb) | explained; interpreted | *And this way have you well expounded it.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **purposed** (verb) | intended | *What can be avoided Whose end is purposed by the mighty gods?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **entrails** (noun) | internal organs (of a sacrificed animal) | *Plucking the entrails of an offering forth, They could not find a heart within the beast.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beggars** (noun) | very poor people who ask for money | *When beggars die, there are no comets seen; The heavens themselves blaze forth the death of princes.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **signified** (verb) | meant; shown | *This by Calpurnia's dream is signified.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **cowardice** (noun) | lack of courage | *The gods do this in shame of cowardice: Caesar should be a beast without a heart, If he should stay at home to-day for fear.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **wonders** (noun) | the feeling aroused by something strange and surprising | *Of all the wonders that I yet have heard, It seems to me most strange that men should fear; Seeing that death, a necessary end, Will come when it will come.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What famous line does Caesar speak about cowards and death? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cowards die many times before their deaths; the valiant taste death once.
2. What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: It spouted blood that Romans bathed in
3. What do the augurs find in the sacrificed animal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: No heart
4. How does Decius reinterpret the dream? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar
5. What does Decius say the Senate plans to give Caesar? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A crown
6. Why does Caesar change his mind and go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act II, Scene II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome drawing life from Caesar, and says the Senate means to crown him and will mock him if he stays for a…
8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.” What does “predictions” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: predictions: statements about what will happen.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Caesar speak of himself in the third person ('Caesar shall go forth')? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: He treats himself as a public monument; it shows pride and self-image.
2. What does “Act II, Scene II” suggest about Calpurnia's dream? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about Calpurnia's dream? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
5. In the passage that begins “Cowards die many times before their deaths; The valiant never taste of death but once.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Calpurnia has dreamed of Caesar's statue spouting blood while Romans bathed their hands in it, and begs him to stay home. The augurs find no heart in a sacrificed beast. Caesar first boasts that danger knows he is more dangerous than it, then agrees to stay. Decius reinterprets the dream as Rome…
7. How does “Act II, Scene II” build on “Act II, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever done something risky because you were afraid of looking scared?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Which matters more in Caesar's decision: pride or fate? Argue with evidence from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Decius's appeal to pride is decisive, though omens foreshadow fate.
2. A critic might argue: “Caesar's pride and fear of looking weak are what Decius exploits, mirroring how Cassius worked on Brutus. Dramatic irony is strong: the audience knows the men greeting him as friends will kill him.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Calpurnia's dream. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Act II, Scene II" treats Calpurnia's dream with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act II, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Calpurnia's dream? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue?
   A. It spouted blood that Romans bathed in
   B. It wept
   C. It turned to gold
   D. It fell and broke
2. What do the augurs find in the sacrificed animal?
   A. No heart
   B. Two hearts
   C. A snake
   D. A coin
3. How does Decius reinterpret the dream?
   A. Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar
   B. Calpurnia is jealous
   C. Caesar will die soon
   D. The gods are angry
4. What does Decius say the Senate plans to give Caesar?
   A. A crown

B. A triumph

C. An army

D. A temple

5. Why does Caesar change his mind and go?

A. Antony insists

B. The augurs approve

C. He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream

D. Calpurnia changes her mind

6. In the line “Yet Caesar shall go forth; for these predictions Are to the world in general as to Caesar.”, what does “predictions” most nearly mean?

A. intended

B. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

C. explained; interpreted

D. statements about what will happen

7. In the line “And this way have you well expounded it.”, what does “expounded” most nearly mean?

A. intended

B. statements about what will happen

C. explained; interpreted

D. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

**Answer key:** 1. A (It spouted blood that Romans bathed in); 2. A (No heart); 3. A (Rome will draw reviving blood from Caesar); 4. A (A crown); 5. C (He fears being mocked for heeding a wife's dream); 6. D (statements about what will happen); 7. C (explained; interpreted)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show Calpurnia's dream? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act II, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Calpurnia's dream? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of Calpurnia's dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II,

Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Calpurnia's dream. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about Calpurnia's dream. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Calpurnia's dream. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Calpurnia's dream responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Calpurnia's dream follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene II and its treatment of Calpurnia's dream. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Calpurnia's dream in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Calpurnia's dream. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *What can be avoided Whose end is purposed by the mighty gods?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “purposed” most nearly mean?

   A. meant; shown

B. intended

C. lack of courage

D. the feeling aroused by something strange and surprising

2. *Cowards die many times before their deaths; The valiant never taste of death but once. Of all the wonders that I yet have heard, It seems to me most strange that men should fear; Seeing that death, a necessary end, Will come when it will come.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

A. Calpurnia's dream

B. The funeral orations

C. Artemidorus's letter

D. The assassination

**SAT key:** 1. B (intended); 2. A (Calpurnia's dream)

# Lesson 7: Act II, Scene III

**Focus:** Artemidorus's letter

Teacher only · spoilers

Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.

**Background:** This very short scene (Act II, Scene III) builds suspense just before the assassination. Plutarch reports that a man named Artemidorus tried to warn Caesar.

**Significance:** The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are emulation, laments, contrive, befriend, commend. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation." In this sentence it means: envious rivalry. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. This very short scene (Act II, Scene III) builds suspense just before the assassination. Plutarch reports that a man named Artemidorus tried to warn Caesar. Why does this scene matter? The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for structure.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Here will I stand till Caesar pass along, And as a suitor will I give him this." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to Artemidorus's letter? I circle "emulation", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find structure, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for structure.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of structure. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Here will I stand till Caesar pass along, And as a suitor will I give him this. My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation. If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive. Exit.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Structure, Tone / mood, Characterization: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Artemidorus's letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about Artemidorus's letter, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how structure shapes Artemidorus's letter. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **emulation** (noun) | envious rivalry | *My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **laments** (verb) | grieves | *My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **contrive** (verb) | to plot | *If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **befriend** (verb) | to help; to favor | *That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **commend** (verb) | to send greetings; to recommend | *Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **suitors** (noun) | people who bring a request | *Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | to beg | *That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enterprise** (noun) | a bold undertaking | *O Brutus, The heavens speed thee in thine enterprise!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Which conspirators does Artemidorus name in his letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Brutus, Cassius, Casca, Cinna, Trebonius, Metellus Cimber, Decius Brutus and Ligarius.
2. What does Artemidorus's letter contain? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The names of the conspirators
3. Where does Artemidorus plan to give Caesar the letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: In the street as Caesar passes
4. What is Artemidorus's profession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A teacher of rhetoric

5. What does Artemidorus say about virtue? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)
6. What does the letter tell Caesar security gives way to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Conspiracy
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act II, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.
8. Who is on stage in “Act II, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act II, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.” What does “emulation” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: emulation: envious rivalry.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the letter say 'If thou beest not immortal, look about you'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: It punctures Caesar's godlike self-image: he is mortal and must take care.
2. What does “Act II, Scene III” suggest about Artemidorus's letter? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about Artemidorus's letter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
5. In the passage that begins “Here will I stand till Caesar pass along, And as a suitor will I give him this.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Artemidorus, a teacher of rhetoric, reads aloud a letter he has written naming the conspirators and warning Caesar to look about him. He plans to stand in the street and hand it to Caesar on the way to the Capitol, lamenting that virtue cannot live out of reach of envy.
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do stories often add near-misses just before a disaster?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. If Caesar had read the letter, would the play's events have been different? What does this scene suggest about chance? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Accept arguments for chance, character, and fate.
2. A critic might argue: “The warnings multiply as the moment nears, so the assassination feels both preventable and inevitable.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Artemidorus's letter. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats Artemidorus's letter with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act II, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Artemidorus's letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Artemidorus's letter contain?
   A. A request for money
   B. The names of the conspirators
   C. A prophecy
   D. A love poem
2. Where does Artemidorus plan to give Caesar the letter?
   A. In the Senate
   B. At Caesar's house
   C. At the feast
   D. In the street as Caesar passes
3. What is Artemidorus's profession?
   A. A priest
   B. A teacher of rhetoric
   C. A senator
   D. A soldier
4. What does Artemidorus say about virtue?
   A. It always wins
   B. It is rare in Rome
   C. It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)
   D. It is weakness
5. What does the letter tell Caesar security gives way to?
   A. Fortune
   B. Conspiracy
   C. Death
   D. Tyranny
6. In the line “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.”, what does “emulation” most nearly mean?
   A. to help; to favor
   B. to plot
   C. envious rivalry
   D. grieves

7. In the line “My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation.”, what does “laments” most nearly mean?
   A. to help; to favor
   B. grieves
   C. to plot
   D. envious rivalry

**Answer key:** 1. B (The names of the conspirators); 2. D (In the street as Caesar passes); 3. B (A teacher of rhetoric); 4. C (It cannot live out of the teeth of emulation (envy)); 5. B (Conspiracy); 6. C (envious rivalry); 7. B (grieves)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Artemidorus's letter? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Act II, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Artemidorus's letter? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of Artemidorus's letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of Artemidorus's letter. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about Artemidorus's letter. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Artemidorus's letter. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment

of Artemidorus's letter responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Artemidorus's letter follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene III and its treatment of Artemidorus's letter. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Artemidorus's letter in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Artemidorus's letter. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “contrive” most nearly mean?

   A. to beg

   B. people who bring a request

   C. a bold undertaking

   D. to plot

2. *Here will I stand till Caesar pass along, And as a suitor will I give him this. My heart laments that virtue cannot live Out of the teeth of emulation. If thou read this, O Caesar, thou mayst live; If not, the Fates with traitors do contrive. Exit.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act II, Scene III”?

   A. Storm, omens and recruitment

   B. Artemidorus's letter

   C. The funeral orations

   D. Cassius works on Brutus

**SAT key:** 1. D (to plot); 2. B (Artemidorus's letter)

# Lesson 8: Act II, Scene IV

**Focus:** Portia's anxiety

Teacher only · spoilers

Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly gives the secret away.

**Background:** Act II, Scene IV is the last scene before the assassination and the last time Portia appears on stage.

**Significance:** Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are befriend, commend, suitors, beseech, enterprise. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself." In this sentence it means: to help; to favor. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Act II, Scene IV is the last scene before the assassination and the last time Portia appears on stage. Why does this scene matter? Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "None that I know will be, much that I fear may chance." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to Portia's anxiety? I circle "suitors", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *None that I know will be, much that I fear may chance. Good morrow to you. Here the street is narrow: The throng that follows Caesar at the heels, Of senators, of praetors, common suitors, Will crowd a feeble man almost to death: I'll get me to a place more void, and there Speak to great Caesar as he comes along. Exit.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Tone / mood, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about Portia's anxiety, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Portia's anxiety. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **befriend** (verb) | to help; to favor | | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **commend** (verb) | to send greetings; to recommend | *Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **suitors** (noun) | people who bring a request | *Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **beseech** (verb) | to beg | *That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enterprise** (noun) | a bold undertaking | *O Brutus, The heavens speed thee in thine enterprise!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **purpled** (adjective) | stained red with blood | *I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enfranchisement** (noun) | restoration of a citizen's rights | *Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **doomsday** (noun) | the day of final judgment; the end of the world | *Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Portia ask Lucius to report back? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Whether Brutus looks well (he went out sickly), what Caesar does and who presses toward him.

2. Where does Portia send Lucius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: To the Senate house
3. Why can't Portia explain the errand to Lucius? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: She must not reveal the plot
4. Whom does Portia meet in the street? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The soothsayer
5. What does the soothsayer plan to do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Speak to Caesar as he passes
6. What does Portia say about a woman's heart? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: It is weak
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly gives the secret away.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act II, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself." What does "befriend" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: befriend: to help; to favor.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. What does Portia's behavior suggest about the burden Brutus has shared with her? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: The secret torments her; she can barely hide it.
2. What does "Act II, Scene IV" suggest about Portia's anxiety? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about Portia's anxiety? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
5. In the passage that begins "None that I know will be, much that I fear may chance.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act II, Scene IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Portia, nearly frantic with knowledge of the plot, sends the

boy Lucius to the Senate house without being able to say why, then asks him to report how Brutus looks and who comes to Caesar. She questions the soothsayer, who plans to warn Caesar again from a narrow place in the street, and she nearly…

7. How does “Act II, Scene IV” build on “Act II, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What is it like to carry a secret you cannot share?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Portia calls a woman's heart weak, though she wounded herself to prove her strength. How do you read this contradiction? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Accept answers on period gender norms and on strain under pressure.
2. A critic might argue: “Portia's anxiety shows the private cost of a public plot, and prepares for news of her death in Act IV.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act II, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Portia's anxiety. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act II, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats Portia's anxiety with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

9. Predict what "Act III, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Portia's anxiety? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where does Portia send Lucius?
   A. To the Senate house
   B. To Cassius's home
   C. To Antony
   D. To the market
2. Why can't Portia explain the errand to Lucius?
   A. She is ill
   B. She does not trust him
   C. She must not reveal the plot
   D. She has forgotten it
3. Whom does Portia meet in the street?
   A. The soothsayer
   B. Casca
   C. Artemidorus
   D. Calpurnia
4. What does the soothsayer plan to do?
   A. Join the conspirators
   B. Leave Rome
   C. Speak to Caesar as he passes
   D. Warn Brutus
5. What does Portia say about a woman's heart?
   A. It is weak
   B. It cannot love
   C. It is never afraid
   D. It is as strong as a man's

6. In the line “That I have, lady: if it will please Caesar To be so good to Caesar as to hear me, I shall beseech him to befriend himself.”, what does “befriend” most nearly mean?
   A. to help; to favor
   B. to beg
   C. to send greetings; to recommend
   D. people who bring a request
7. In the line “Run, Lucius, and commend me to my lord; Say I am merry: come to me again, And bring me word what he doth say to thee.”, what does “commend” most nearly mean?
   A. to beg
   B. to help; to favor
   C. to send greetings; to recommend
   D. people who bring a request

**Answer key:** 1. A (To the Senate house); 2. C (She must not reveal the plot); 3. A (The soothsayer); 4. C (Speak to Caesar as he passes); 5. A (It is weak); 6. A (to help; to favor); 7. C (to send greetings; to recommend)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act II, Scene IV,” how does Shakespeare show Portia's anxiety? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act II, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Portia's anxiety? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of Portia's anxiety. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Portia's anxiety. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about Portia's anxiety. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Portia's anxiety. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act II, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Portia's anxiety responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act II, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Portia's anxiety follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act II, Scene IV and its treatment of Portia's anxiety. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about Portia's anxiety in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act II, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Portia's anxiety. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Yes, bring me word, boy, if thy lord look well, For he went sickly forth: and take good note What Caesar doth, what suitors press to him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “suitors” most nearly mean?

   A. stained red with blood

   B. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

   C. restoration of a citizen's rights

   D. people who bring a request

2. *None that I know will be, much that I fear may chance. Good morrow to you. Here the street is narrow: The throng that follows Caesar at the heels, Of senators, of praetors, common suitors, Will crowd a feeble man almost to death: I’ll get me to a place more void, and there Speak to great Caesar as he comes along. Exit.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene IV"?

A. The triumvirs' proscription list

B. Cassius works on Brutus

C. The assassination

D. Portia's anxiety

**SAT key:** 1. D (people who bring a request); 2. D (Portia's anxiety)

# Lesson 9: Act III, Scene I

**Focus:** the assassination

**Content note (assassination, blood):** Caesar is stabbed on stage and the conspirators bathe their hands in his blood. Focus on how each side names the act (sacrifice, murder, liberty).
**Student preview:** This scene shows a political killing on stage.
**Suggested language:** "Why do the conspirators want blood on their hands in public?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab; Brutus strikes last ('Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!'). The conspirators bathe their hands in Caesar's blood and cry liberty. Antony sends a servant, then comes himself, shakes their bloody hands and asks to speak at the funeral. Brutus agrees over Cassius's objection, on condition that Antony speaks after him and does not blame them. Alone, Antony prophesies civil war ('Cry Havoc, and let slip the dogs of war'). News comes that Octavius is near Rome.

**Background:** The real assassination took place on 15 March 44 BC in the Theatre of Pompey, where the Senate was meeting; Shakespeare sets it at the Capitol. The words 'Et tu, Brute?' come from earlier English tradition, not Plutarch.

**Significance:** The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This scene shows a political killing on stage.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are purpled, enfranchisement, doomsday, pulpits, abridged. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure." In this sentence it means: stained red with blood. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. The real assassination took place on 15 March 44 BC in the Theatre of Pompey, where the Senate was meeting; Shakespeare sets it at the Capitol. The words 'Et tu, Brute?' come from earlier English tradition, not Plutarch. Why does this scene matter? The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "I must prevent thee, Cimber." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the assassination? I circle "fawning", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find conflict, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for conflict.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *I must prevent thee, Cimber. These couchings and these lowly courtesies Might fire the blood of ordinary men, And turn pre-ordinance and first decree Into the law of children. Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw'd from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court'sies and base spaniel-fawning. Thy brother by decree is banished: If thou dost bend and pray and fawn for him, I spurn thee like a cur out of my way. Know, Caesar doth not wrong, nor without cause Will he be satisfied.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Characterization, Structure: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the assassination, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes the assassination. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **purpled** (adjective) | stained red with blood | *I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enfranchisement** (noun) | restoration of a citizen's rights | *Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **doomsday** (noun) | the day of final judgment; the end of the world | *Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **pulpits** (noun) | platforms for public speaking | *Some to the common pulpits, and cry out "Liberty, freedom, and enfranchisement!"* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **abridged** (verb) | shortened | *Grant that, and then is death a benefit: So are we Caesar's friends, that have abridged His time of fearing death.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **besmear** (verb) | to smear all over | *Stoop, Romans, stoop, And let us bathe our hands in Caesar's blood Up to the elbows, and besmear our swords: Then walk we forth, even to the market-place, And, waving our red weapons o'er our heads, Let's all cry "Peace, freedom and liberty!"* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **fawning** (verb) | flattering like a dog | *Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw'd from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court'sies and base spaniel-fawning.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **proclaim** (verb) | to declare publicly | *Run hence, proclaim, cry it about the streets.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **funeral** (noun) | a ceremony for a dead person | *That's all I seek: And am moreover suitor that I may Produce his body to the market-place; And in the pulpit, as becomes a friend, Speak in the order of his funeral.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **prevention** (noun) | being stopped before acting | *Casca, be sudden, for we fear prevention.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Who draws Antony away before the attack? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Trebonius.
2. Who strikes Caesar first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Casca
3. To what does Caesar compare himself just before the attack? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The northern star
4. Whose banished brother does Metellus Cimber plead for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: His own
5. What condition does Brutus set on Antony's funeral speech? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators
6. What does Antony predict in his soliloquy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Civil war
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab; Brutus strikes last ('Et tu, Brute? Then fall, Caesar!'). The conspirators bathe their hands in…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act III, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.” What does “purpled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: purpled: stained red with blood.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Antony shake each conspirator's bloody hand? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: To appear reconciled and win the chance to speak at the funeral.
2. What does “Act III, Scene I” suggest about the assassination? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the assassination? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. In the passage that begins “I must prevent thee, Cimber.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Caesar brushes aside the soothsayer ('the ides of March are come') and refuses to read Artemidorus's letter first. Trebonius draws Antony away. Metellus Cimber pleads for his banished brother; Caesar refuses, calling himself 'constant as the northern star.' Casca strikes first; the others stab;…
7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a story place its most famous event in the middle rather than at the end?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Cassius predicts letting Antony speak is a mistake. Was Brutus's decision noble, naive, or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Strong answers weigh Brutus's honor against political judgment.

2. A critic might argue: “The climax comes at the midpoint of the play. Brutus's second mistake (letting Antony speak) turns the play from a story of conspiracy into one of revenge.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the assassination. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats the assassination with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the assassination? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who strikes Caesar first?

   A. Casca

   B. Brutus

   C. Cassius

   D. Cinna

2. To what does Caesar compare himself just before the attack?
   A. The sun
   B. A lion
   C. A mountain
   D. The northern star
3. Whose banished brother does Metellus Cimber plead for?
   A. Cicero's
   B. Antony's
   C. Brutus's
   D. His own
4. What condition does Brutus set on Antony's funeral speech?
   A. He must speak first
   B. He must speak in Greek
   C. He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators
   D. He must not mention Caesar
5. What does Antony predict in his soliloquy?
   A. Civil war
   B. A new king
   C. Peace
   D. Brutus's coronation
6. In the line “I do beseech ye, if you bear me hard, Now, whilst your purpled hands do reek and smoke, Fulfil your pleasure.”, what does “purpled” most nearly mean?
   A. stained red with blood
   B. the day of final judgment; the end of the world
   C. restoration of a citizen's rights
   D. platforms for public speaking
7. In the line “Pardon, Caesar; Caesar, pardon: As low as to thy foot doth Cassius fall, To beg enfranchisement for Publius Cimber.”, what does “enfranchisement” most nearly mean?
   A. the day of final judgment; the end of the world
   B. restoration of a citizen's rights
   C. stained red with blood
   D. platforms for public speaking

**Answer key:** 1. A (Casca); 2. D (The northern star); 3. D (His own); 4. C (He must speak after Brutus and not blame the conspirators); 5. A (Civil war); 6. A (stained red with blood); 7. B (restoration of a citizen's rights)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene I,” how does Shakespeare show the assassination? Write a paragraph

that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act III, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the assassination? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of the assassination. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the assassination. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about the assassination. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the assassination. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the assassination responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the assassination follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene I and its treatment of the assassination. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the assassination in Julius

Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the assassination. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Fled to his house amazed: Men, wives and children stare, cry out and run As it were doomsday.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “doomsday” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare publicly

   B. being stopped before acting

   C. a ceremony for a dead person

   D. the day of final judgment; the end of the world

2. *I must prevent thee, Cimber. These couchings and these lowly courtesies Might fire the blood of ordinary men, And turn pre-ordinance and first decree Into the law of children. Be not fond, To think that Caesar bears such rebel blood That will be thaw’d from the true quality With that which melteth fools; I mean, sweet words, Low-crooked court’sies and base spaniel-fawning. Thy brother by decree is banished: If thou dost bend and pray and fawn for him, I spurn thee like a cur out of my way. Know, Caesar doth not wrong, nor without cause Will he be satisfied.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene I”?

   A. Young Cato and Lucilius

   B. Portia's anxiety

   C. Cassius works on Brutus

   D. The assassination

**SAT key:** 1. D (the day of final judgment; the end of the world); 2. D (The assassination)

# Lesson 10: Act III, Scene II

**Focus:** the funeral orations

Teacher only · spoilers

Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony; recalls Caesar refusing the crown; weeps; shows the torn, bloody mantle; and finally reads Caesar's will, which leaves every citizen seventy-five drachmas and his private gardens. The crowd riots to burn the conspirators' houses. Antony hears Octavius is in Rome and that Brutus and Cassius have fled.

**Background:** Roman funeral orations (laudationes) praised the dead in public. Rhetoric, the study of persuasion, was central to Roman and Elizabethan education; students practiced ethos, pathos and logos.

**Significance:** This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are extenuated, withholds, ransoms, drachmas, disprove. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death." In this sentence it means: played down; made to seem less. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Roman funeral orations (laudationes) praised the dead in public. Rhetoric, the study of persuasion, was central to Roman and Elizabethan education; students practiced ethos, pathos and logos. Why does this scene matter? This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for theme.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Then none have I offended." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the funeral orations? I circle "extenuated", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find theme, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for theme.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of theme. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Then none have I offended. I have done no more to Caesar than you shall do to Brutus. The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Theme, Characterization, Structure: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the funeral orations, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how theme shapes the funeral orations. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### Vocabulary with etymology notes

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **extenuated** (verb) | played down; made to seem less | *The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **withholds** (verb) | holds back | *You all did love him once, not without cause: What cause withholds you then, to mourn for him?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ransoms** (noun) | payments to free captives | *He hath brought many captives home to Rome, Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill: Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **drachmas** (noun) | silver coins | *To every Roman citizen he gives, To every several man, seventy-five drachmas.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **disprove** (verb) | to show to be false | *I speak not to disprove what Brutus spoke, But here I am to speak what I do know.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **daggers** (noun) | short knives used as weapons | *I have o'ershot myself to tell you of it: I fear I wrong the honourable men Whose daggers have stabb'd Caesar; I do fear it.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **vesture** (noun) | clothing; here, Caesar's cloak | *Kind souls, what, weep you when you but behold Our Caesar's vesture wounded?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **brutish** (adjective) | like a beast; without reason | *O judgment! thou art fled to brutish beasts, And men have lost their reason.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **villains** (noun) | base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers) | *They were villains, murderers: the will! read the will.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bondman** (noun) | a slave | *Who is here so base that would be a bondman?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### Discussion questions

1. Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

### Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What does Antony say Caesar did when offered the crown three times on the Lupercal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He refused it each time.
2. Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Prose
3. What phrase does Antony repeat about Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Brutus is an honourable man
4. How much money does Caesar's will leave each citizen? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Seventy-five drachmas
5. What does Antony show the crowd? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Caesar's torn mantle and wounds
6. Why did Brutus say he killed Caesar? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Caesar was ambitious
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony; recalls Caesar refusing the crown; weeps; shows the torn, bloody mantle; and finally reads Caesar's…
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death." What does "extenuated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: extenuated: played down; made to seem less.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony hold back the will until late in the speech? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: To build curiosity and anger so its reading sets off the riot.
2. What does "Act III, Scene II" suggest about the funeral orations? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.
3. Find one example of theme in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the funeral orations? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

5. In the passage that begins “Then none have I offended.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Brutus speaks to the plebeians in prose: he loved Caesar, but loved Rome more; Caesar was ambitious, so he killed him. The crowd cheers and even shouts to make Brutus Caesar. Brutus leaves Antony to speak. Antony, in verse, repeats that 'Brutus is an honourable man' until the phrase turns to irony;…
7. How does “Act III, Scene II” build on “Act III, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Which persuades you more, a logical argument or an emotional story? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Antony's speech honest? Separate true statements from manipulations. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: True facts (refused crown, the will) serve a manipulative design.
2. A critic might argue: “This is the play's great study in persuasion. Brutus appeals to reason and his own honor; Antony uses repetition, irony, props, delay and emotion. The crowd's swing shows how rhetoric can move a republic toward violence.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the funeral orations. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

7. Is the theme in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Act III, Scene II" treats the funeral orations with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act III, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the funeral orations? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse?
   A. Prose
   B. Verse
   C. Latin
   D. Song
2. What phrase does Antony repeat about Brutus?
   A. Brutus loved Caesar
   B. Brutus is wise
   C. Brutus is a traitor
   D. Brutus is an honourable man
3. How much money does Caesar's will leave each citizen?
   A. Ten drachmas
   B. One hundred talents
   C. Seventy-five drachmas
   D. Nothing
4. What does Antony show the crowd?
   A. A crown
   B. The conspirators' letters
   C. Caesar's torn mantle and wounds
   D. A dagger

5. Why did Brutus say he killed Caesar?
   A. The gods ordered it
   B. Caesar stole money
   C. Caesar was ambitious
   D. Caesar was cruel to him
6. In the line "The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.", what does "extenuated" most nearly mean?
   A. silver coins
   B. played down; made to seem less
   C. holds back
   D. payments to free captives
7. In the line "You all did love him once, not without cause: What cause withholds you then, to mourn for him?", what does "withholds" most nearly mean?
   A. payments to free captives
   B. silver coins
   C. played down; made to seem less
   D. holds back

**Answer key:** 1. A (Prose); 2. D (Brutus is an honourable man); 3. C (Seventy-five drachmas); 4. C (Caesar's torn mantle and wounds); 5. C (Caesar was ambitious); 6. B (played down; made to seem less); 7. D (holds back)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act III, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show the funeral orations? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): In Act III, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the funeral orations? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of the funeral orations. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the funeral orations. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about the funeral orations. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses theme in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the funeral orations. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the funeral orations responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the funeral orations follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene II and its treatment of the funeral orations. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the funeral orations in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the funeral orations. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *He hath brought many captives home to Rome, Whose ransoms did the general coffers fill: Did this in Caesar seem ambitious?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ransoms” most nearly mean?

   A. like a beast; without reason

   B. payments to free captives

   C. base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)

   D. a slave

2. *Then none have I offended. I have done no more to Caesar than you shall do to Brutus. The question of his death is enrolled in the Capitol; his glory not extenuated, wherein he was worthy, nor his offences enforced, for which he suffered death.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene II"?

A. The assassination

B. The funeral orations

C. The triumvirs' proscription list

D. Cassius works on Brutus

**SAT key:** 1. B (payments to free captives); 2. B (The funeral orations)

# Lesson 11: Act III, Scene III

**Focus:** Cinna the poet

**Content note (mob violence):** An innocent poet is killed by a mob that confuses his name with a conspirator's. Discuss the link between rhetoric and crowd violence without dwelling on the act.
**Student preview:** A crowd attacks an innocent man.
**Suggested language:** "What made this crowd stop listening?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.

**Background:** Plutarch reports that the poet Helvius Cinna was killed by a mob that mistook him for the conspirator Cornelius Cinna.

**Significance:** This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: What happens to truth when a crowd is angry? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: A crowd attacks an innocent man.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are bachelor, funeral, provender, errands, appoint. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Are you a married man or a bachelor?" In this sentence it means: an unmarried man. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Plutarch reports that the poet Helvius Cinna was killed by a mob that mistook him for the conspirator Cornelius Cinna. Why does this scene matter? This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "What is my name?" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to Cinna the poet? I circle "bachelor", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find conflict, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for conflict.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *What is my name? Whither am I going? Where do I dwell? Am I a married man or a bachelor? Then, to answer every man directly and briefly, wisely and truly: wisely I say, I am a bachelor.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Theme, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about Cinna the poet, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes Cinna the poet. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### Vocabulary with etymology notes

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **bachelor** (noun) | an unmarried man | *Are you a married man or a bachelor?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **funeral** (noun) | a ceremony for a dead person | *Directly, I am going to Caesar's funeral.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **provender** (noun) | food for horses | *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **errands** (noun) | small tasks for others | *This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **appoint** (verb) | to provide for; to equip | *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conference** (noun) | a private talk | *With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enlarge** (verb) | to state freely; to explain fully | *Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ceremony** (noun) | formal politeness | *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### Discussion questions

1. What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

### Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What questions does the mob ask Cinna? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: His name, where he is going, where he lives, whether he is married.
2. Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He shares a name with a conspirator
3. What did Cinna dream before going out? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: That he feasted with Caesar
4. Where is Cinna going? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: To Caesar's funeral
5. What do the plebeians say to tear him for? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: His bad verses
6. Does the mob stop when they learn he is the poet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: No
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act III, Scene III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act III, Scene III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Are you a married man or a bachelor?" What does "bachelor" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: bachelor: an unmarried man.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare include this scene right after the orations? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: To show the human cost of inflamed rhetoric.
2. What does "Act III, Scene III" suggest about Cinna the poet? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about Cinna the poet? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
5. In the passage that begins "What is my name?", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Cinna the poet, who has dreamed of feasting with Caesar, goes out to the funeral. A mob of plebeians questions him. When he gives his name, they confuse him with Cinna the conspirator; when he protests that he is the poet, they cry 'Tear him for his bad verses' and kill him anyway.
7. How does “Act III, Scene III” build on “Act III, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens to truth when a crowd is angry?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is this scene comic, horrifying, or both? How would you stage it, and why? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Accept justified choices; note the dark humor and violence.
2. A critic might argue: “This short scene shows the result of Antony's speech: a mob that no longer listens to reason. It darkly mirrors the conspirators' own violence. Note: this scene depicts mob violence; preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Cinna the poet. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Cinna the poet with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

9. Predict what "Act IV, Scene I" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Cinna the poet? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet?
   A. He praised Brutus
   B. He shares a name with a conspirator
   C. He stole from them
   D. He insulted Caesar
2. What did Cinna dream before going out?
   A. That Caesar was crowned
   B. That he was attacked
   C. That he feasted with Caesar
   D. That Rome burned
3. Where is Cinna going?
   A. To Brutus's house
   B. To Caesar's funeral
   C. Out of Rome
   D. To the Senate
4. What do the plebeians say to tear him for?
   A. His lies
   B. His bad verses
   C. His wealth
   D. His dreams
5. Does the mob stop when they learn he is the poet?
   A. Only for a moment, then let him go
   B. No
   C. Yes
   D. They apologize

6. In the line “Are you a married man or a bachelor?”, what does “bachelor” most nearly mean?
   A. food for horses
   B. an unmarried man
   C. a ceremony for a dead person
   D. small tasks for others
7. In the line “Directly, I am going to Caesar’s funeral.”, what does “funeral” most nearly mean?
   A. small tasks for others
   B. a ceremony for a dead person
   C. food for horses
   D. an unmarried man

**Answer key:** 1. B (He shares a name with a conspirator); 2. C (That he feasted with Caesar); 3. B (To Caesar's funeral); 4. B (His bad verses); 5. B (No); 6. B (an unmarried man); 7. B (a ceremony for a dead person)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act III, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show Cinna the poet? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act III, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Cinna the poet? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Cinna the poet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Cinna the poet. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Cinna the poet. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's

understanding of Cinna the poet. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act III, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Cinna the poet responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act III, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Cinna the poet follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act III, Scene III and its treatment of Cinna the poet. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act III, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about Cinna the poet in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act III, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Cinna the poet. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “provender” most nearly mean?

   A. a private talk

   B. to state freely; to explain fully

   C. formal politeness

   D. food for horses

2. *What is my name? Whither am I going? Where do I dwell? Am I a married man or a bachelor? Then, to answer every man directly and briefly, wisely and truly: wisely I say, I am a bachelor.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act III, Scene III”?

   A. The triumvirs' proscription list

   B. Cinna the poet

   C. Cassius works on Brutus

D. Parley before battle

**SAT key:** 1. D (food for horses); 2. B (Cinna the poet)

# Lesson 12: Act IV, Scene I

**Focus:** the triumvirs' proscription list

Teacher only · spoilers

Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends him as a soldier. They plan to meet the armies of Brutus and Cassius.

**Background:** In 43 BC the Second Triumvirate published proscription lists of enemies to be killed and their property seized; the orator Cicero was among the victims.

**Significance:** The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples. No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are provender, errands, appoint, conference, enlarge. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit." In this sentence it means: food for horses. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. In 43 BC the Second Triumvirate published proscription lists of enemies to be killed and their property seized; the orator Cicero was among the victims. Why does this scene matter? The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the triumvirs' proscription list? I circle "provender", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit. And, in some taste, is Lepidus but so; He must be taught and train'd and bid go forth; A barren-spirited fellow; one that feeds On objects, orts and imitations, Which, out of use and staled by other men, Begin his fashion: do not talk of him, But as a property. And now, Octavius, Listen great things:—Brutus and Cassius Are levying powers: we must straight make head: Therefore let our alliance be combined, Our best friends made, our means stretch'd; And let us presently go sit in council, How covert matters may be best disclosed, And open perils surest answered.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Theme, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the triumvirs' proscription list, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the triumvirs' proscription list. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **provender** (noun) | food for horses | *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **errands** (noun) | small tasks for others | *This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **appoint** (verb) | to provide for; to equip | *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **conference** (noun) | a private talk | *With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enlarge** (verb) | to state freely; to explain fully | *Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ceremony** (noun) | formal politeness | *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **jigging** (adjective) | rhyming in a silly, sing-song way | *I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **counters** (noun) | worthless metal tokens used in counting | *When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Whose brother must die on the triumvirs' list? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Lepidus's brother.
2. What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Marking names of men to be killed
3. Whose nephew is condemned? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Antony's
4. What does Antony plan to do with Caesar's will? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cut some of its charges
5. To what animal does Antony compare Lepidus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A horse
6. Who defends Lepidus as a tried and valiant soldier? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Octavius
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends him as a soldier. They plan to meet the armies of Brutus and Cassius.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit." What does "provender" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: provender: food for horses.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. What does the scene reveal about how Antony views power? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: As a matter of tools and advantage; allies are used and discarded.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene I" suggest about the triumvirs' proscription list? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The 'avengers' of Caesar

prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.

3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the triumvirs' proscription list? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
5. In the passage that begins “So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Antony, Octavius and Lepidus mark men for death, trading relatives: Lepidus's brother and Antony's nephew are condemned. Antony plans to cut costs from Caesar's will. When Lepidus leaves, Antony calls him a 'slight unmeritable man' fit only for errands, comparing him to a horse; Octavius defends…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene I” build on “Act III, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Do people who win power by attacking tyranny ever become tyrants themselves? Think of examples.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Compare this scene with Antony's funeral speech. Which shows the 'real' Antony? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Strong answers see both as performances of one strategic self.
2. A critic might argue: “The 'avengers' of Caesar prove as ruthless as the conspirators and more cynical. Antony's plan to reduce the people's legacy undercuts his funeral speech.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the triumvirs' proscription list. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene I” treats the triumvirs' proscription list with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the triumvirs' proscription list? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene?
   A. Planning Caesar's funeral
   B. Marking names of men to be killed
   C. Writing laws
   D. Dividing the army
2. Whose nephew is condemned?
   A. Lepidus's
   B. Antony's
   C. Octavius's
   D. Brutus's
3. What does Antony plan to do with Caesar's will?
   A. Read it again

B. Give more to the people

C. Cut some of its charges

D. Burn it

4. To what animal does Antony compare Lepidus?

A. A lion

B. A donkey

C. A dog

D. A horse

5. Who defends Lepidus as a tried and valiant soldier?

A. Antony

B. Brutus

C. Octavius

D. Cassius

6. In the line "So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.", what does "provender" most nearly mean?

A. a private talk

B. food for horses

C. small tasks for others

D. to provide for; to equip

7. In the line "This is a slight unmeritable man, Meet to be sent on errands: is it fit, The three-fold world divided, he should stand One of the three to share it?", what does "errands" most nearly mean?

A. to provide for; to equip

B. food for horses

C. a private talk

D. small tasks for others

**Answer key:** 1. B (Marking names of men to be killed); 2. B (Antony's); 3. C (Cut some of its charges); 4. D (A horse); 5. C (Octavius); 6. B (food for horses); 7. D (small tasks for others)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show the triumvirs' proscription list? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act IV, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the triumvirs' proscription list. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the triumvirs' proscription list. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the triumvirs' proscription list. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the triumvirs' proscription list. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the triumvirs' proscription list follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene I and its treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about the triumvirs' proscription list in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the triumvirs' proscription list. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist,

psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "appoint" most nearly mean?

   A. to provide for; to equip

   B. worthless metal tokens used in counting

   C. formal politeness

   D. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way

2. *So is my horse, Octavius; and for that I do appoint him store of provender: It is a creature that I teach to fight, To wind, to stop, to run directly on, His corporal motion govern'd by my spirit. And, in some taste, is Lepidus but so; He must be taught and train'd and bid go forth; A barren-spirited fellow; one that feeds On objects, orts and imitations, Which, out of use and staled by other men, Begin his fashion: do not talk of him, But as a property. And now, Octavius, Listen great things:—Brutus and Cassius Are levying powers: we must straight make head: Therefore let our alliance be combined, Our best friends made, our means stretch'd; And let us presently go sit in council, How covert matters may be best disclosed, And open perils surest answered.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

   A. The assassination

   B. Portia's anxiety

   C. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

   D. The triumvirs' proscription list

**SAT key:** 1. A (to provide for; to equip); 2. D (The triumvirs' proscription list)

# Lesson 13: Act IV, Scene II

**Focus:** Brutus and Cassius at odds

Teacher only · spoilers

At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.

**Background:** Sardis was a city in Asia Minor (modern Turkey) where Brutus and Cassius gathered forces after leaving Rome.

**Significance:** The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Why might friends who share a cause still fall out? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are conference, enlarge, ceremony, jigging, counters. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old." In this sentence it means: a private talk. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Sardis was a city in Asia Minor (modern Turkey) where Brutus and Cassius gathered forces after leaving Rome. Why does this scene matter? The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to Brutus and Cassius at odds? I circle "ceremony", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find conflict, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for conflict.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony. There are no tricks in plain and simple faith; But hollow men, like horses hot at hand, Make gallant show and promise of their mettle; But when they should endure the bloody spur, They fall their crests, and, like deceitful jades, Sink in the trial. Comes his army on?*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Characterization, Structure: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about Brutus and Cassius at odds, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes Brutus and Cassius at odds. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **conference** (noun) | a private talk | *With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **enlarge** (verb) | to state freely; to explain fully | *Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ceremony** (noun) | formal politeness | *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **jigging** (adjective) | rhyming in a silly, sing-song way | *I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **counters** (noun) | worthless metal tokens used in counting | *When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **niggard** (verb) | to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep) | *The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **itching** (adjective) | greedy (an itching palm wants bribes) | *Let me tell you, Cassius, you yourself Are much condemn'd to have an itching palm; To sell and mart your offices for gold To undeservers.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **thunderbolts** (noun) | bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon) | *When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. Who brings news of Cassius's approach and his cold manner? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Lucilius (with Pindarus, Cassius's servant).
2. How does Lucilius say Cassius received him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: With courtesy but not old friendliness
3. To what does Brutus compare a cooling friend? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Horses that fail under trial
4. Where does Brutus want to argue with Cassius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Inside his tent
5. What does Cassius accuse Brutus of? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Wronging him
6. Near which city is Brutus's camp? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Sardis
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act IV, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old." What does "conference" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: conference: a private talk.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Brutus insist the quarrel move into the tent? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: So the soldiers do not see their leaders divided.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene II" suggest about Brutus and Cassius at odds? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Brutus and Cassius at odds? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

5. In the passage that begins “Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: At his camp near Sardis, Brutus tells Lucilius that Cassius greets him with cold ceremony, like a hot horse that fails under trial. Cassius arrives angry, saying Brutus has wronged him. Brutus stops him from quarreling before their armies and moves the conversation into his tent.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene II” build on “Act IV, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might friends who share a cause still fall out?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Brutus right to care so much about appearances in front of the army? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Accept leadership arguments; link to his public-honor theme.
2. A critic might argue: “The alliance is cracking. Brutus's care for appearances (no quarrel in front of the soldiers) repeats his concern with public honor.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Brutus and Cassius at odds. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Act IV, Scene II" treats Brutus and Cassius at odds with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act IV, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Brutus and Cassius at odds? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. How does Lucilius say Cassius received him?
   A. With great warmth
   B. With open anger
   C. With courtesy but not old friendliness
   D. With tears
2. To what does Brutus compare a cooling friend?
   A. Old wine
   B. Horses that fail under trial
   C. A dying fire
   D. Winter
3. Where does Brutus want to argue with Cassius?
   A. Before the armies
   B. In Rome
   C. On the battlefield
   D. Inside his tent
4. What does Cassius accuse Brutus of?
   A. Loving Antony
   B. Stealing
   C. Wronging him
   D. Betraying Rome

5. Near which city is Brutus's camp?
   A. Sardis
   B. Philippi
   C. Rome
   D. Athens
6. In the line "With courtesy and with respect enough; But not with such familiar instances, Nor with such free and friendly conference, As he hath used of old.", what does "conference" most nearly mean?
   A. to state freely; to explain fully
   B. formal politeness
   C. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   D. a private talk
7. In the line "Before the eyes of both our armies here, Which should perceive nothing but love from us, Let us not wrangle: bid them move away; Then in my tent, Cassius, enlarge your griefs, And I will give you audience.", what does "enlarge" most nearly mean?
   A. formal politeness
   B. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   C. a private talk
   D. to state freely; to explain fully

**Answer key:** 1. C (With courtesy but not old friendliness); 2. B (Horses that fail under trial); 3. D (Inside his tent); 4. C (Wronging him); 5. A (Sardis); 6. D (a private talk); 7. D (to state freely; to explain fully)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene II," how does Shakespeare show Brutus and Cassius at odds? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act IV, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about Brutus and Cassius at odds. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Brutus and Cassius at odds follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene II and its treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about Brutus and Cassius at odds in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Brutus and Cassius at odds. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ceremony” most nearly mean?

   A. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)

   B. bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon)

   C. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)

   D. formal politeness

2. *Thou hast described A hot friend cooling: ever note, Lucilius, When love begins to sicken and decay, It useth an enforced ceremony. There are no tricks in plain and simple faith; But hollow men, like horses hot at hand, Make gallant show and promise of their mettle; But when they should endure the bloody spur, They fall their crests, and, like deceitful jades, Sink in the trial. Comes his army on?*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene II"?

A. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

B. Parley before battle

C. Portia's anxiety

D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

**SAT key:** 1. D (formal politeness); 2. D (Brutus and Cassius at odds)

# Lesson 14: Act IV, Scene III

**Focus:** the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

**Content note (suicide (reported)):** Brutus reports that Portia 'swallow'd fire.' Use the safe-messaging script; focus on Brutus's response and the strain of the war.
**Student preview:** This scene reports a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "What does Brutus's reaction show about him?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus his dagger and his heart; they reconcile. Brutus reveals that Portia is dead: she 'swallow'd fire.' Messala brings news that the triumvirs have killed many senators (seventy or a hundred), Cicero among them. Brutus overrules Cassius again and decides to march to Philippi: 'There is a tide in the affairs of men.' Late at night, as Lucius sleeps, Caesar's ghost appears and says Brutus will see him at Philippi.

**Background:** Plutarch reports that Brutus saw a spirit before the battle, calling itself his evil genius. Portia's death is reported in two ways in the scene (Brutus tells Cassius, then appears to learn it again from Messala), which many editors think shows two versions of the scene surviving in the Folio.

**Significance:** The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This scene reports a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are jigging, counters, niggard, itching, thunderbolts. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?" In this sentence it means: rhyming in a silly, sing-song way. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Plutarch reports that Brutus saw a spirit before the battle, calling itself his evil genius. Portia's death is reported in two ways in the scene (Brutus tells Cassius, then appears to learn it again from Messala), which many editors think shows two versions of the scene surviving in the Folio. Why does this scene matter? The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "That you have wrong'd me doth appear in this: You have condemn'd and noted Lucius Pella For taking bribes here of the Sardians; Wherein my letters, praying on his side, Because I knew the man, were slighted off." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? When I find conflict, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for conflict.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *That you have wrong'd me doth appear in this: You have condemn'd and noted Lucius Pella For taking bribes here of the Sardians; Wherein my letters, praying on his side, Because I knew the man, were slighted off.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **jigging** (adjective) | rhyming in a silly, sing-song way | *I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **counters** (noun) | worthless metal tokens used in counting | *When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **niggard** (verb) | to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep) | *The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **itching** (adjective) | greedy (an itching palm wants bribes) | *Let me tell you, Cassius, you yourself Are much condemn'd to have an itching palm; To sell and mart your offices for gold To undeservers.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **thunderbolts** (noun) | bolts of lightning (Jove's weapon) | *When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **meditating** (verb) | reflect deeply on a subject | *We must die, Messala: With meditating that she must die once, I have the patience to endure it now.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| | happening by chance | | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **accidental** (adjective) | | *Of your philosophy you make no use, If you give place to accidental evils.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **commend** (verb) | to send greetings; to recommend | *Go and commend me to my brother Cassius; Bid him set on his powers betimes before, And we will follow.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

**Literal / recall**

1. Which famous senator does Messala report was killed by the triumvirs? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cicero.
2. What does Brutus accuse Cassius of having? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: An itching palm
3. Why is Brutus angry that Cassius denied him gold? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He needed it to pay his legions
4. How did Portia die, as Brutus reports? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: She swallowed fire
5. Where does Brutus decide to march? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: To Philippi
6. What does the ghost tell Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He will see him at Philippi
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act IV, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus his dagger and his heart; they reconcile. Brutus reveals that Portia is dead: she 'swallow'd fire.'…
8. Who is on stage in “Act IV, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act IV, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I’ll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?” What does “jigging” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: jigging: rhyming in a silly, sing-song way.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why might Brutus hide his grief about Portia when Messala brings the news? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: To appear stoic and steady in front of his officers.
2. What does “Act IV, Scene III” suggest about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. In the passage that begins “That you have wrong’d me doth appear in this: You have condemn’d and noted Lucius Pella For taking bribes here of the Sardians; Wherein my letters, praying on his side, Because I…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: In the tent, Cassius protests that Brutus condemned Lucius Pella for bribery despite his letters. Brutus accuses Cassius of an 'itching palm' and of refusing him gold to pay his legions, while insisting he himself will not raise money by vile means. They trade insults until Cassius offers Brutus…
7. How does “Act IV, Scene III” build on “Act IV, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can someone stay perfectly principled while leading an army? What would it cost?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Brutus refuses to raise money by 'vile means' but expects Cassius's gold. Is that hypocrisy or idealism? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Strong answers note he benefits from methods he condemns.
2. A critic might argue: “The quarrel exposes the gap between Brutus's ideals and the realities of war. His third bad decision (to march to Philippi) and the ghost both point to the ending. Note: this scene reports a suicide (Portia); preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Brutus accuse Cassius of having?
   A. A coward's tongue
   B. A cold heart
   C. An itching palm
   D. A traitor's face
2. Why is Brutus angry that Cassius denied him gold?
   A. He wanted to bribe Antony
   B. He owed Portia
   C. He needed it to pay his legions
   D. He wanted to buy a crown
3. How did Portia die, as Brutus reports?
   A. She swallowed fire
   B. She fell ill
   C. She was poisoned
   D. She drowned
4. Where does Brutus decide to march?
   A. To Philippi
   B. Back to Rome
   C. To Sardis
   D. To Egypt
5. What does the ghost tell Brutus?
   A. Portia forgives him
   B. Antony will win
   C. He should flee
   D. He will see him at Philippi
6. In the line "I'll know his humour, when he knows his time: What should the wars do with these jigging fools?", what does "jigging" most nearly mean?
   A. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   B. worthless metal tokens used in counting
   C. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)
   D. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)
7. In the line "When Marcus Brutus grows so covetous, To lock such rascal counters from his friends, Be ready, gods, with all your thunderbolts; Dash him to pieces!", what does "counters" most nearly mean?
   A. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)
   B. rhyming in a silly, sing-song way
   C. greedy (an itching palm wants bribes)
   D. worthless metal tokens used in counting

**Answer key:** 1. C (An itching palm); 2. C (He needed it to pay his legions); 3. A (She swallowed fire); 4. A (To Philippi); 5. D (He will see him at Philippi); 6. A (rhyming in a silly, sing-song way); 7. D (worthless metal tokens used in counting)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act IV, Scene III," how does Shakespeare show the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act IV, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act IV, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act IV, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act IV, Scene III and its treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act IV, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *The deep of night is crept upon our talk, And nature must obey necessity; Which we will niggard with a little rest.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “niggard” most nearly mean?

   A. reflect deeply on a subject

   B. to send greetings; to recommend

   C. to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)

   D. happening by chance

2. *That you have wrong’d me doth appear in this: You have condemn’d and noted Lucius Pella For taking bribes here of the Sardians; Wherein my letters, praying on his side, Because I knew the man, were slighted off.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act IV, Scene III”?

   A. Brutus decides

   B. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   C. Artemidorus's letter

   D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

**SAT key:** 1. C (to supply sparingly (here, to cut short with a little sleep)); 2. B (The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost)

# Lesson 15: Act V, Scene I

**Focus:** parley before battle

Teacher only · spoilers

At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his birthday and that he now half believes in omens: eagles have left their banners and ravens fly overhead. Brutus and Cassius say farewell, uncertain whether they will meet again; Brutus says he would not go bound to Rome.

**Background:** The battles of Philippi in Macedonia (42 BC) ended the republican cause. Cassius had followed Epicurus, whose followers did not believe omens.

**Significance:** Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: How do people prepare to face something they may not survive? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are stomachs, presage, avenged, posture, arguing. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs." In this sentence it means: courage; appetite for battle. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. The battles of Philippi in Macedonia (42 BC) ended the republican cause. Cassius had followed Epicurus, whose followers did not believe omens. Why does this scene matter? Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to parley before battle? I circle "avenged", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find conflict, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for conflict.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops. Look; I draw a sword against conspirators; When think you that the sword goes up again? Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Characterization, Structure: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about parley before battle, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes parley before battle. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **stomachs** (noun) | courage; appetite for battle | *Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **presage** (verb) | to foretell | *You know that I held Epicurus strong And his opinion: now I change my mind, And partly credit things that do presage.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **avenged** (verb) | paid back with punishment | *Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **posture** (noun) | stance; manner of attack | *Antony, The posture of your blows are yet unknown; But for your words, they rob the Hybla bees, And leave them honeyless.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **arguing** (noun) | debating; quarreling | *Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **overthrow** (noun) | defeat | *Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **envenomed** (adjective) | poisoned | *Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **engender** (verb) | to give rise to | *O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate, omens and free will?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. How many wounds does Octavius say Caesar received? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Three and thirty.
2. Where does the battle take place? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Philippi
3. What does Cassius tell Messala about this day? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: It is his birthday
4. Which birds does Cassius say have replaced the eagles? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Ravens, crows and kites
5. Whose philosophy had Cassius followed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Epicurus
6. What does Brutus say he will never do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Go bound to Rome as a captive
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene I” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his birthday and that he now half believes in omens: eagles have left their banners and ravens fly…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs.” What does “stomachs” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: stomachs: courage; appetite for battle.

### Inferential / analytical

1. What does Octavius's refusal to take Antony's command suggest about the future? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: He will not be Antony's junior; he will rise to rule.
2. What does “Act V, Scene I” suggest about parley before battle? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about parley before battle? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

5. In the passage that begins “Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: At Philippi, Octavius notes the enemy has come down to fight. The generals meet and exchange insults: Antony mocks the conspirators' flattery of Caesar; Cassius reminds Brutus he should have killed Antony. Octavius refuses to give way to Antony's order on the field. Cassius tells Messala it is his…
7. How does “Act V, Scene I” build on “Act IV, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do people prepare to face something they may not survive?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with fate, omens and free will? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Brutus's and Cassius's farewells are tender. Does that change how you judge them? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Accept answers on friendship versus political guilt.
2. A critic might argue: “Octavius's quiet defiance of Antony foreshadows the future (he will become the emperor Augustus). Cassius's change of mind on omens and the farewells build dread.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of parley before battle. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to power, ambition and tyranny: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Act V, Scene I" treats parley before battle with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act V, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about parley before battle? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where does the battle take place?
   A. Sardis
   B. Philippi
   C. Rome
   D. Actium
2. What does Cassius tell Messala about this day?
   A. It is Portia's birthday
   B. It is his birthday
   C. It is a holy day
   D. It is the ides of March
3. Which birds does Cassius say have replaced the eagles?
   A. Swans
   B. Doves
   C. Ravens, crows and kites
   D. Owls
4. Whose philosophy had Cassius followed?
   A. Epicurus
   B. Zeno
   C. Plato
   D. Socrates

5. What does Brutus say he will never do?
   A. Read the will
   B. Forgive Cassius
   C. Fight Antony
   D. Go bound to Rome as a captive
6. In the line "Defiance, traitors, hurl we in your teeth: If you dare fight to-day, come to the field; If not, when you have stomachs.", what does "stomachs" most nearly mean?
   A. to foretell
   B. paid back with punishment
   C. stance; manner of attack
   D. courage; appetite for battle
7. In the line "You know that I held Epicurus strong And his opinion: now I change my mind, And partly credit things that do presage.", what does "presage" most nearly mean?
   A. paid back with punishment
   B. stance; manner of attack
   C. courage; appetite for battle
   D. to foretell

**Answer key:** 1. B (Philippi); 2. B (It is his birthday); 3. C (Ravens, crows and kites); 4. A (Epicurus); 5. D (Go bound to Rome as a captive); 6. D (courage; appetite for battle); 7. D (to foretell)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene I," how does Shakespeare show parley before battle? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act V, Scene I, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of parley before battle? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of parley before battle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of parley before battle. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about parley before battle. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of parley before battle. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene I within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of parley before battle responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of parley before battle follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene I and its treatment of parley before battle. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene I as evidence for a larger claim about parley before battle in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene I as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of parley before battle. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "avenged" most nearly mean?

   A. paid back with punishment

   B. to give rise to

   C. poisoned

   D. defeat

2. *Come, come, the cause: if arguing make us sweat, The proof of it will turn to redder drops. Look; I draw a sword against conspirators; When think you that the sword goes up again? Never, till Caesar's three and thirty wounds Be well avenged; or till another Caesar Have added slaughter to the sword of traitors.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

A. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

B. Parley before battle

C. Portia's anxiety

D. Storm, omens and recruitment

**SAT key:** 1. A (paid back with punishment); 2. B (Parley before battle)

# Lesson 16: Act V, Scene II

**Focus:** the first charge

Teacher only · spoilers

Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.

**Background:** Act V, Scene II is one of the shortest scenes in Shakespeare, a quick cut in battle.

**Significance:** Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are overthrow, envenomed, engender, garland, revenged. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow." In this sentence it means: defeat. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Act V, Scene II is one of the shortest scenes in Shakespeare, a quick cut in battle. Why does this scene matter? Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for structure.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the first charge? I circle "overthrow", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find structure, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for structure.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of structure. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow. Ride, ride, Messala: let them all come down. Exeunt.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Structure, Conflict, Setting: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the first charge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the first charge, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how structure shapes the first charge. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **overthrow** (noun) | defeat | *Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **envenomed** (adjective) | poisoned | *Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **engender** (verb) | to give rise to | *O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **garland** (noun) | a wreath worn as a sign of victory | *But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **revenged** (adjective) | avenged | *Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill'd thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **freeman** (noun) | a free person, no longer a slave | *Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar's bowels, search this bosom.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bondman** (noun) | a slave | *All disconsolate, With Pindarus his bondman, on this hill.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **villains** (noun) | base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers) | *O, look, Titinius, look, the villains fly!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?
2. Where does structure appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Brutus want his legions to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Set on (charge) at once.
2. Whom does Brutus send with the orders? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Messala

3. Which wing of the enemy does Brutus plan to attack? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Octavius's
4. Why does Brutus think the attack will work? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He sees coldness in Octavius's wing
5. How does Brutus send his instructions? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Written bills
6. How long is this scene compared with others? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Very short
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow." What does "overthrow" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: overthrow: defeat.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. What can you infer about Brutus's mood from this brief scene? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Urgent, hopeful, perhaps rash.
2. What does "Act V, Scene II" suggest about the first charge? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield.
3. Find one example of structure in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about the first charge? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
5. In the passage that begins "Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side.", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act V, Scene II", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Brutus sends Messala with written orders for his legions to charge at once, because he sees coldness in Octavius's wing and hopes a sudden attack will overthrow it.
7. How does "Act V, Scene II" build on "Act V, Scene I"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "How do filmmakers and playwrights show the confusion of battle?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with power, ambition and tyranny? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Why might Shakespeare break the battle into many short scenes rather than one long one? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Pacing, confusion, multiple viewpoints.
2. A critic might argue: "Brutus's eagerness in battle mirrors his haste in other decisions; the quick cutting between scenes creates the feel of a confused battlefield." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing "Act V, Scene II". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the first charge. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about "Act V, Scene II": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to honor and self-deception: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the structure in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Act V, Scene II" treats the first charge with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act V, Scene III" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the first charge? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Whom does Brutus send with the orders?
   A. Titinius
   B. Messala
   C. Pindarus
   D. Lucilius
2. Which wing of the enemy does Brutus plan to attack?
   A. Octavius's
   B. Cassius's
   C. Antony's
   D. Lepidus's
3. Why does Brutus think the attack will work?
   A. The gods favor him
   B. He sees coldness in Octavius's wing
   C. Antony is ill
   D. Cassius told him
4. How does Brutus send his instructions?
   A. A trumpet signal
   B. Written bills
   C. A messenger bird
   D. A shouted command
5. How long is this scene compared with others?
   A. About average
   B. It has no lines
   C. The longest in the play
   D. Very short
6. In the line “Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius’ wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow.”, what does “overthrow” most nearly mean?
   A. a wreath worn as a sign of victory
   B. to give rise to
   C. defeat
   D. poisoned

7. In the line “Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.”, what does “envenomed” most nearly mean?

   A. defeat

   B. poisoned

   C. to give rise to

   D. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

**Answer key:** 1. B (Messala); 2. A (Octavius's); 3. B (He sees coldness in Octavius's wing); 4. B (Written bills); 5. D (Very short); 6. C (defeat); 7. B (poisoned)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene II,” how does Shakespeare show the first charge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Act V, Scene II, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the first charge? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the first charge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the first charge. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the first charge. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's structure and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses structure in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the first charge. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene II within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the first charge responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the first charge follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene II and its treatment of the first charge. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's structure and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene II as evidence for a larger claim about the first charge in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene II as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the first charge. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "engender" most nearly mean?

   A. a free person, no longer a slave

   B. base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)

   C. to give rise to

   D. a slave

2. *Ride, ride, Messala, ride, and give these bills Unto the legions on the other side. Loud alarum. Let them set on at once; for I perceive But cold demeanour in Octavius' wing, And sudden push gives them the overthrow. Ride, ride, Messala: let them all come down. Exeunt.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. Young Cato and Lucilius

   B. The quarrel, Portia's death and the ghost

   C. The first charge

   D. Storm, omens and recruitment

**SAT key:** 1. C (to give rise to); 2. C (The first charge)

# Lesson 17: Act V, Scene III

**Focus:** the death of Cassius

**Content note (suicide):** Cassius and Titinius take their own lives after a misunderstanding. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss Roman honor codes critically and the role of misinformation, not methods.
**Student preview:** This scene shows two deaths by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "How did a mistake lead to this outcome?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword that killed Caesar: 'Caesar, thou art revenged.' Titinius returns with a victory garland from Brutus, finds Cassius dead, and kills himself. Brutus arrives, mourns Cassius as 'the last of all the Romans' and resolves to fight again.

**Background:** Plutarch reports that Cassius died on his birthday, killed by his freedman Pindarus at his own command, after misreading the battle.

**Significance:** A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This scene shows two deaths by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are envenomed, engender, garland, revenged, freeman. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight." In this sentence it means: poisoned. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Plutarch reports that Cassius died on his birthday, killed by his freedman Pindarus at his own command, after misreading the battle. Why does this scene matter? A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for conflict.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the death of Cassius? I circle "revenged", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find conflict, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for conflict.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of conflict. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it. Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar's bowels, search this bosom. Stand not to answer: here, take thou the hilts; And, when my face is cover'd, as 'tis now, Guide thou the sword. Pindarus stabs him. Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill'd thee. Dies.*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Conflict, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the death of Cassius, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how conflict shapes the death of Cassius. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **envenomed** (adjective) | poisoned | *Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **engender** (verb) | to give rise to | *O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill'st the mother that engender'd thee!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **garland** (noun) | a wreath worn as a sign of victory | *But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **revenged** (adjective) | avenged | *Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill'd thee.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **freeman** (noun) | a free person, no longer a slave | *Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar's bowels, search this bosom.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bondman** (noun) | a slave | *All disconsolate, With Pindarus his bondman, on this hill.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **villains** (noun) | base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers) | *O, look, Titinius, look, the villains fly!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **entrails** (noun) | internal organs (of a sacrificed animal) | *Thy spirit walks abroad, and turns our swords In our own proper entrails.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with honor and self-deception?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What reward does Cassius promise Pindarus for killing him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: His freedom.
2. What does Pindarus mistakenly report? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: That Titinius has been captured
3. With what does Cassius ask to be killed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The sword that killed Caesar
4. What does Titinius bring back for Cassius? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A wreath of victory from Brutus
5. What does Brutus call Cassius? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The last of all the Romans
6. What does Brutus say Caesar's spirit does? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Turns their swords against themselves
7. Retell the three most important events of “Act V, Scene III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword that killed Caesar: 'Caesar, thou art revenged.' Titinius returns with a victory garland from…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene III”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “Act V, Scene III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this…” What does “envenomed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: envenomed: poisoned.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why does Cassius believe Pindarus without checking? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Despair and his birthday omens; he expects defeat.
2. What does “Act V, Scene III” suggest about the death of Cassius? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the death of Cassius? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. In the passage that begins “Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Cassius's men are fleeing; Brutus's troops have charged too early and turned to looting. Cassius sends Titinius to see whether nearby troops are friend or foe and asks Pindarus to watch. Pindarus mistakenly reports Titinius captured. Believing all lost, Cassius has Pindarus stab him with the sword…
7. How does “Act V, Scene III” build on “Act V, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can a single misunderstanding lead to disaster?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with honor and self-deception? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Cassius's death noble in the Roman sense or simply tragic? Discuss with care for the topic. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Discuss Roman honor codes vs. a modern view; use safe messaging.
2. A critic might argue: “A death built on misunderstanding: Brutus says Caesar's spirit 'turns our swords in our own proper entrails.' Note: this scene shows two suicides; preview with students.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the death of Cassius. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to rhetoric and persuasion: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats the death of Cassius with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what “Act V, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the death of Cassius? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Pindarus mistakenly report?
   A. That Titinius has been captured
   B. That Brutus is dead
   C. That Rome is burning
   D. That Antony has fled
2. With what does Cassius ask to be killed?
   A. Poison
   B. The sword that killed Caesar
   C. A spear
   D. Fire
3. What does Titinius bring back for Cassius?
   A. Antony's sword
   B. A letter from Portia
   C. A wreath of victory from Brutus
   D. A crown
4. What does Brutus call Cassius?
   A. A traitor
   B. The last of all the Romans
   C. His enemy
   D. A coward
5. What does Brutus say Caesar's spirit does?
   A. Forgives them
   B. Haunts Antony
   C. Protects Rome
   D. Turns their swords against themselves
6. In the line “Seek him, Titinius, whilst I go to meet The noble Brutus, thrusting this report Into his ears; I may say, thrusting it; For piercing steel and darts envenomed Shall be as welcome to the ears of Brutus As tidings of this sight.”, what does “envenomed” most nearly mean?
   A. a wreath worn as a sign of victory
   B. poisoned
   C. avenged
   D. to give rise to
7. In the line “O error, soon conceived, Thou never comest unto a happy birth, But kill’st the mother that engender’d thee!”, what does “engender” most nearly mean?
   A. a wreath worn as a sign of victory
   B. avenged
   C. to give rise to
   D. poisoned

**Answer key:** 1. A (That Titinius has been captured); 2. B (The sword that killed Caesar); 3. C (A wreath of victory from Brutus); 4. B (The last of all the Romans); 5. D (Turns their swords against themselves); 6. B (poisoned); 7. C (to give rise to)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Act V, Scene III,” how does Shakespeare show the death of Cassius? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act V, Scene III, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the death of Cassius? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of the death of Cassius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the death of Cassius. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about the death of Cassius. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses conflict in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the death of Cassius. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene III within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the death of Cassius responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the death of

Cassius follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene III and its treatment of the death of Cassius. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene III as evidence for a larger claim about the death of Cassius in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene III as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the death of Cassius. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *But, hold thee, take this garland on thy brow; Thy Brutus bid me give it thee, and I Will do his bidding.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “garland” most nearly mean?

   A. a slave

   B. internal organs (of a sacrificed animal)

   C. a wreath worn as a sign of victory

   D. base, low fellows (here, cowardly soldiers)

2. *Come hither, sirrah: In Parthia did I take thee prisoner; And then I swore thee, saving of thy life, That whatsoever I did bid thee do, Thou shouldst attempt it. Come now, keep thine oath; Now be a freeman: and with this good sword, That ran through Caesar’s bowels, search this bosom. Stand not to answer: here, take thou the hilts; And, when my face is cover’d, as ’tis now, Guide thou the sword. Pindarus stabs him. Caesar, thou art revenged, Even with the sword that kill’d thee. Dies.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene III”?

   A. The death of Cassius

   B. The first charge

   C. Parley before battle

   D. The tribunes and the fickle crowd

**SAT key:** 1. C (a wreath worn as a sign of victory); 2. A (The death of Cassius)

# Lesson 18: Act V, Scene IV

**Focus:** young Cato and Lucilius

Teacher only · spoilers

Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.

**Background:** Young Cato was the son of Cato the Younger, a famous defender of the republic, and the brother of Portia.

**Significance:** Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are tyrants, kindness, proclaim, chanced, tarrying. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!" In this sentence it means: cruel and unjust rulers. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Young Cato was the son of Cato the Younger, a famous defender of the republic, and the brother of Portia. Why does this scene matter? Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "What bastard doth not?" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to young Cato and Lucilius? I circle "tyrants", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *What bastard doth not? Who will go with me? I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho! A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Conflict, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of young Cato and Lucilius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about young Cato and Lucilius, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes young Cato and Lucilius. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **tyrants** (noun) | cruel and unjust rulers | *A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **kindness** (noun) | kind treatment | *This is not Brutus, friend; but, I assure you, A prize no less in worth: keep this man safe; Give him all kindness: I had rather have Such men my friends than enemies.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **proclaim** (verb) | to declare publicly | *I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **chanced** (verb) | happened | *Go on, And see whether Brutus be alive or dead; And bring us word unto Octavius' tent How everything is chanced.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **tarrying** (verb) | staying; lingering | *Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **slaying** (noun) | killing | *Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bondage** (noun) | slavery; captivity | *Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **entertain** (verb) | to take into service | *All that served Brutus, I will entertain them.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Lucilius say about Brutus being taken alive? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: No enemy shall ever take noble Brutus alive.
2. Who pretends to be Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Lucilius
3. Why does Lucilius pretend to be Brutus? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: To protect him
4. Who recognizes the trick? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Antony
5. How does Antony order Lucilius to be treated? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Kindly

6. Whose son is young Cato? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Cato the Younger's
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!" What does "tyrants" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: tyrants: cruel and unjust rulers.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antony value Lucilius? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: His loyalty would make him a valuable friend.
2. What does "Act V, Scene IV" suggest about young Cato and Lucilius? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about young Cato and Lucilius? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
5. In the passage that begins "What bastard doth not?", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act V, Scene IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Young Cato, Portia's brother, proclaims his name and is killed. Lucilius pretends to be Brutus to protect him and is captured. Antony recognizes the trick, orders that Lucilius be treated kindly, and says he would rather have such men as friends than enemies.
7. How does "Act V, Scene IV" build on "Act V, Scene III"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "What does loyalty look like when a cause is losing?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with rhetoric and persuasion? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Lucilius's deception admirable even though it is a lie? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Weigh loyalty against honesty.
2. A critic might argue: "Lucilius's loyalty and Antony's generosity show that honor and kindness survive even in defeat." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing "Act V, Scene IV". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of young Cato and Lucilius. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
5. Write three questions of your own about "Act V, Scene IV": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to public versus private self: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how "Act V, Scene IV" treats young Cato and Lucilius with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. Predict what "Act V, Scene V" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about young Cato and Lucilius? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who pretends to be Brutus?
   A. Messala
   B. Lucilius
   C. Titinius
   D. Cato
2. Why does Lucilius pretend to be Brutus?
   A. To flee
   B. To trick Cassius
   C. To win a reward
   D. To protect him
3. Who recognizes the trick?
   A. Octavius
   B. Antony
   C. Lepidus
   D. Pindarus
4. How does Antony order Lucilius to be treated?
   A. Executed
   B. Imprisoned harshly
   C. Kindly
   D. Sent away
5. Whose son is young Cato?
   A. Cato the Younger's
   B. Caesar's
   C. Brutus's
   D. Cicero's
6. In the line “A foe to tyrants, and my country’s friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!”, what does “tyrants” most nearly mean?
   A. happened
   B. cruel and unjust rulers
   C. to declare publicly
   D. kind treatment
7. In the line “This is not Brutus, friend; but, I assure you, A prize no less in worth: keep this man safe; Give him all kindness: I had rather have Such men my friends than enemies.”, what does “kindness” most nearly mean?
   A. happened
   B. kind treatment

C. cruel and unjust rulers

D. to declare publicly

**Answer key:** 1. B (Lucilius); 2. D (To protect him); 3. B (Antony); 4. C (Kindly); 5. A (Cato the Younger's); 6. B (cruel and unjust rulers); 7. B (kind treatment)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene IV," how does Shakespeare show young Cato and Lucilius? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act V, Scene IV, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of young Cato and Lucilius? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of young Cato and Lucilius. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of young Cato and Lucilius. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene IV suggests about young Cato and Lucilius. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act V, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of young Cato and Lucilius. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of young Cato and Lucilius responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of young Cato and Lucilius follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene IV and its treatment of young Cato and Lucilius. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as evidence for a larger claim about young Cato and Lucilius in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene IV as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of young Cato and Lucilius. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*

   As used in the text, what does the word “proclaim” most nearly mean?

   A. to declare publicly

   B. slavery; captivity

   C. to take into service

   D. killing

2. *What bastard doth not? Who will go with me? I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho! A foe to tyrants, and my country’s friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Act V, Scene IV”?

   A. The triumvirs' proscription list

   B. Calpurnia's dream

   C. Young Cato and Lucilius

   D. Brutus and Cassius at odds

**SAT key:** 1. A (to declare publicly); 2. C (Young Cato and Lucilius)

# Lesson 19: Act V, Scene V

**Focus:** the death of Brutus

**Content note (suicide):** Brutus dies by suicide with Strato's help. Use the safe-messaging script; keep focus on Antony's verdict and the play's questions about honor.
**Student preview:** This scene shows a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "Is Antony's final judgment of Brutus fair?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius arrive. Antony calls Brutus 'the noblest Roman of them all,' the only conspirator who acted for the common good, not envy. Octavius orders an honorable burial and ends the play.

**Background:** Plutarch reports that Brutus died by his own hand after Philippi, assisted by Strato, in 42 BC. Octavius later became Augustus, Rome's first emperor, ending the republic Brutus tried to save.

**Significance:** The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Settle in and write for five minutes: Can a person be noble and still be wrong? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This scene shows a death by suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
*Today's words are tarrying, slaying, bondage, entertain, elements. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here." In this sentence it means: staying; lingering. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Present the historical and literary background.
*Here is what the first readers of Julius Caesar would have known. Plutarch reports that Brutus died by his own hand after Philippi, assisted by Strato, in 42 BC. Octavius later became Augustus, Rome's first emperor, ending the republic Brutus tried to save. Why does this scene matter? The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support. Write down one question you want answered.*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
*Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "This was the noblest Roman of them all: All the conspirators save only he Did that they did in envy of great Caesar; He only, in a general honest thought And common good to all, made one of them." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the death of Brutus? I circle "elements", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.*

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
*Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.*

> *This was the noblest Roman of them all: All the conspirators save only he Did that they did in envy of great Caesar; He only, in a general honest thought And common good to all, made one of them. His life was gentle, and the elements So mix'd in him that Nature might stand up And say to all the world "This was a man!"*

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
*Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Theme, Structure: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) I will circulate and conference.*

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions (focus set for the class level): wait time, think-pair-share on DOK 3/4, follow-up probes.
*Let's talk. We move from what happens to why it matters to whether it's right. After each question I wait before calling on anyone: think first. Our anchor question: How does this scene connect to power, ambition and tyranny? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence, and end by writing one question of your own.*

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Scene quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
*Take the scene quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this scene suggests about the death of Brutus, backed by one short quotation.*

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the death of Brutus. Tonight, read the next scene and add two words to your etymology log.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **tarrying** (verb) | staying; lingering | *Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **slaying** (noun) | killing | *Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bondage** (noun) | slavery; captivity | *Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **entertain** (verb) | to take into service | *All that served Brutus, I will entertain them.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **elements** (noun) | the basic qualities that make up a person | *His life was gentle, and the elements So mix'd in him that Nature might stand up And say to all the world "This was a man!"* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **proclaim** (verb) | to declare publicly | *I will proclaim my name about the field: I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **tyrants** (noun) | cruel and unjust rulers | *A foe to tyrants, and my country's friend; I am the son of Marcus Cato, ho!* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **chanced** (verb) | happened | *Go on, And see whether Brutus be alive or dead; And bring us word unto Octavius' tent How everything is chanced.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can a person be noble and still be wrong?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with public versus private self?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Where did Caesar's ghost appear again to Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: In the fields of Philippi.
2. Who holds the sword for Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Strato
3. What does Brutus say to Caesar as he dies? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He killed Caesar with less good will than himself
4. What does Antony call Brutus? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: The noblest Roman of them all
5. Why does Antony say Brutus was different from the other conspirators? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: He acted for the common good, not envy
6. Who speaks the play's final lines? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Octavius
7. Retell the three most important events of "Act V, Scene V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius arrive. Antony calls Brutus 'the noblest Roman of them all,' the only conspirator who acted for the…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Act V, Scene V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here." What does "tarrying" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1] Look for: tarrying: staying; lingering.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. Why do Brutus's servants refuse to help him die? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Love and loyalty; they cannot bring themselves to do it.
2. What does "Act V, Scene V" suggest about the death of Brutus? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.

3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the death of Brutus? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
5. In the passage that begins “This was the noblest Roman of them all: All the conspirators save only he Did that they did in envy of great Caesar; He only, in a general honest thought And common good to all,…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Defeated, Brutus asks Clitus, Dardanius and Volumnius in turn to help him die; all refuse. He tells them Caesar's ghost appeared to him again at Philippi. Strato holds his sword and Brutus runs on it, saying 'Caesar, now be still: I kill'd not thee with half so good a will.' Antony and Octavius…
7. How does “Act V, Scene V” build on “Act V, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a person be noble and still be wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with public versus private self? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Antony praises Brutus after doing everything to destroy him. Is the tribute sincere, political, or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Accept justified readings; note Octavius takes command.
2. A critic might argue: “The play closes with Antony's tribute, which reframes Brutus. Irony: the act meant to preserve the republic helped bring about the empire. Note: this scene depicts suicide; use safe messaging and offer support.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the death of Brutus. [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Act V, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
6. Connect this scene to fate, omens and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
8. Compare how “Act V, Scene V” treats the death of Brutus with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Julius Caesar see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve public versus private self? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the death of Brutus? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who holds the sword for Brutus?
   A. Volumnius
   B. Clitus
   C. Strato
   D. Messala
2. What does Brutus say to Caesar as he dies?
   A. He forgives Caesar
   B. He will see him in Rome
   C. He killed Caesar with less good will than himself
   D. He was right
3. What does Antony call Brutus?
   A. A traitor
   B. A coward
   C. A fool
   D. The noblest Roman of them all

4. Why does Antony say Brutus was different from the other conspirators?
   A. He acted for the common good, not envy
   B. He planned the plot
   C. He was the bravest fighter
   D. He was Caesar's son
5. Who speaks the play's final lines?
   A. Strato
   B. Octavius
   C. Antony
   D. Lucilius
6. In the line "Fly, fly, my lord; there is no tarrying here.", what does "tarrying" most nearly mean?
   A. staying; lingering
   B. killing
   C. slavery; captivity
   D. to take into service
7. In the line "Sit thee down, Clitus: slaying is the word; It is a deed in fashion.", what does "slaying" most nearly mean?
   A. killing
   B. slavery; captivity
   C. staying; lingering
   D. to take into service

**Answer key:** 1. C (Strato); 2. C (He killed Caesar with less good will than himself); 3. D (The noblest Roman of them all); 4. A (He acted for the common good, not envy); 5. B (Octavius); 6. A (staying; lingering); 7. A (killing)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this play is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Act V, Scene V," how does Shakespeare show the death of Brutus? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Act V, Scene V, how does Shakespeare develop the idea of the death of Brutus? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of the death of Brutus. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the death of Brutus. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene V suggests about the death of Brutus. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act V, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of the death of Brutus. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Act V, Scene V within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the death of Brutus responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Act V, Scene V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the death of Brutus follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Act V, Scene V and its treatment of the death of Brutus. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Act V, Scene V as evidence for a larger claim about the death of Brutus in Julius Caesar. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Act V, Scene V as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the death of Brutus. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Julius Caesar.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Free from the bondage you are in, Messala: The conquerors can but make a fire of him; For Brutus only overcame himself, And no man else hath honour by his death.*

As used in the text, what does the word "bondage" most nearly mean?

A. to declare publicly

B. slavery; captivity

C. cruel and unjust rulers

D. happened

2. *This was the noblest Roman of them all: All the conspirators save only he Did that they did in envy of great Caesar; He only, in a general honest thought And common good to all, made one of them. His life was gentle, and the elements So mix'd in him that Nature might stand up And say to all the world "This was a man!"*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene V"?

A. Brutus and Cassius at odds

B. Cassius works on Brutus

C. The death of Brutus

D. Cinna the poet

**SAT key:** 1. B (slavery; captivity); 2. C (The death of Brutus)

# Whole-book test

**Julius Caesar: whole-book test** · 90 minutes

## Part I: Multiple choice

1. Who are the two women named in the cast list?
   A. Lucretia and Portia
   B. Calpurnia and Cleopatra
   C. Calpurnia and Portia
   D. Portia and Octavia
2. Why are the commoners out in the streets?
   A. To protest taxes
   B. To elect tribunes
   C. To celebrate Caesar's triumph
   D. To see a play
3. What does the soothsayer warn Caesar to beware?
   A. The Capitol
   B. Cassius
   C. The Lupercal
   D. The ides of March
4. What strange sight does Casca report about a slave's hand?
   A. It burned but was not scorched
   B. It held a crown
   C. It bled
   D. It turned to stone
5. To what does Brutus compare Caesar in his soliloquy?
   A. A serpent's egg
   B. A lion
   C. A falling star
   D. A storm
6. What did Calpurnia dream about Caesar's statue?
   A. It spouted blood that Romans bathed in
   B. It wept
   C. It turned to gold
   D. It fell and broke
7. What does Artemidorus's letter contain?
   A. A request for money

B. The names of the conspirators

C. A prophecy

D. A love poem

8. Where does Portia send Lucius?

A. To the Senate house

B. To Cassius's home

C. To Antony

D. To the market

9. Who strikes Caesar first?

A. Casca

B. Brutus

C. Cassius

D. Cinna

10. Does Brutus speak to the crowd in prose or verse?

A. Prose

B. Verse

C. Latin

D. Song

11. Why does the mob attack Cinna the poet?

A. He praised Brutus

B. He shares a name with a conspirator

C. He stole from them

D. He insulted Caesar

12. What are the triumvirs doing at the start of the scene?

A. Planning Caesar's funeral

B. Marking names of men to be killed

C. Writing laws

D. Dividing the army

13. How does Lucilius say Cassius received him?

A. With great warmth

B. With open anger

C. With courtesy but not old friendliness

D. With tears

14. What does Brutus accuse Cassius of having?

A. A coward's tongue

B. A cold heart

C. An itching palm

D. A traitor's face

15. Where does the battle take place?
    A. Sardis
    B. Philippi
    C. Rome
    D. Actium
16. Whom does Brutus send with the orders?
    A. Titinius
    B. Messala
    C. Pindarus
    D. Lucilius
17. What does Pindarus mistakenly report?
    A. That Titinius has been captured
    B. That Brutus is dead
    C. That Rome is burning
    D. That Antony has fled
18. Who pretends to be Brutus?
    A. Messala
    B. Lucilius
    C. Titinius
    D. Cato
19. Who holds the sword for Brutus?
    A. Volumnius
    B. Clitus
    C. Strato
    D. Messala

## Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how power, ambition and tyranny develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
2. Explain how honor and self-deception develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.
3. Explain how rhetoric and persuasion develops from the beginning of the play to the end. Use two scenes.

## Part III: Essay

Choose one of the play's central concerns (power, ambition and tyranny, honor and self-deception, rhetoric and persuasion, public versus private self, fate, omens and free will) and argue how the ending reframes it.

## Answer key

**Answer key:** 1. C (Calpurnia and Portia); 2. C (To celebrate Caesar's triumph); 3. D (The ides of March); 4. A (It burned but was not scorched); 5. A (A serpent's egg); 6. A (It spouted blood that Romans bathed in); 7. B (The names of the conspirators); 8. A (To the Senate house); 9. A (Casca); 10. A (Prose); 11. B (He shares a name with a conspirator); 12. B (Marking names of men to be killed); 13. C (With courtesy but not old friendliness); 14. C (An itching palm); 15. B (Philippi); 16. B (Messala); 17. A (That Titinius has been captured); 18. B (Lucilius); 19. C (Strato)

# Essay assignments

## Essay: Power, ambition and tyranny

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about power, ambition and tyranny. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops power, ambition and tyranny across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of power, ambition and tyranny. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of power, ambition and tyranny, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of power, ambition and tyranny in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar. Name your critical

method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on power, ambition and tyranny in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Honor and self-deception

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about honor and self-deception. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops honor and self-deception across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of honor and self-deception. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of honor and self-deception, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of honor and self-deception in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on honor and self-deception in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Rhetoric and persuasion

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about rhetoric and persuasion. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops rhetoric and persuasion across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of rhetoric and persuasion. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of rhetoric and persuasion, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of rhetoric and persuasion in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on rhetoric and persuasion in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Public versus private self

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about public versus private self. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops public versus private self across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of public versus private self. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of public versus private self, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of public versus private self in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on public versus private self in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on public versus private self in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about public versus private self in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on public versus private self in Julius

Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Fate, omens and free will

**Middle School** (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Julius Caesar teaches about fate, omens and free will. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how William Shakespeare develops fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate, omens and free will across Julius Caesar. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Julius Caesar (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate, omens and free will. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Julius Caesar (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate, omens and free will, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Julius Caesar's treatment of fate, omens and free will in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate, omens and free will in Julius Caesar, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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